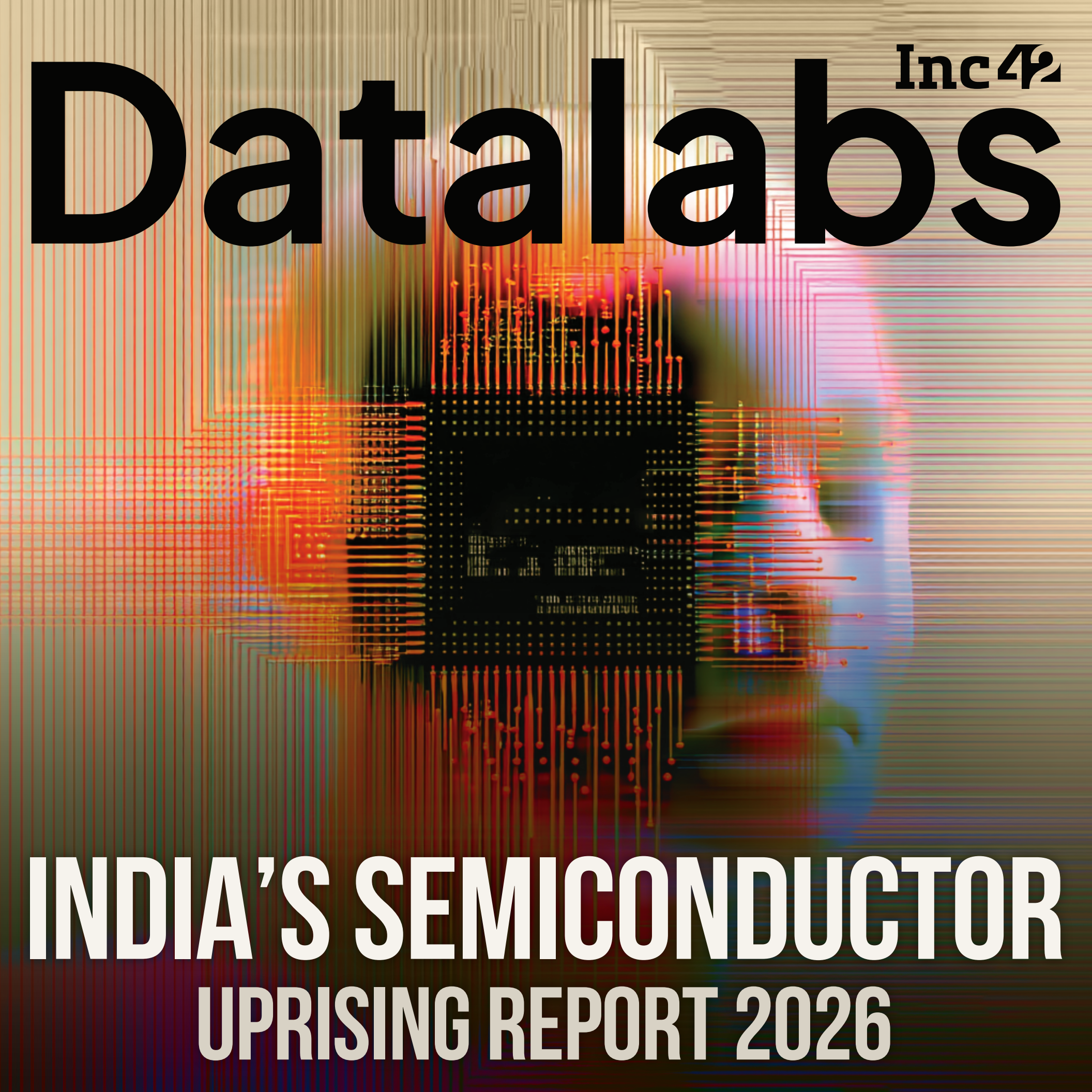


Datalabs^{Inc42}



**INDIA'S SEMICONDUCTOR
UPRISING REPORT 2026**

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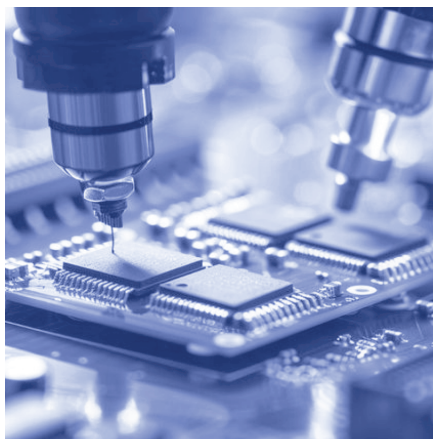
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

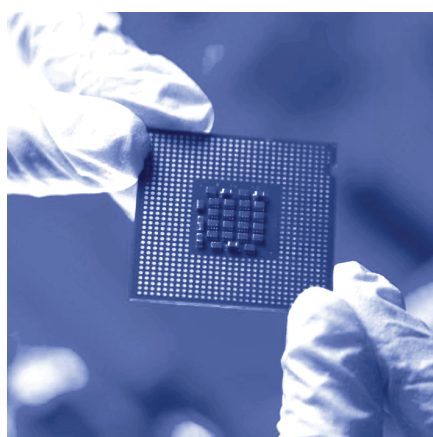
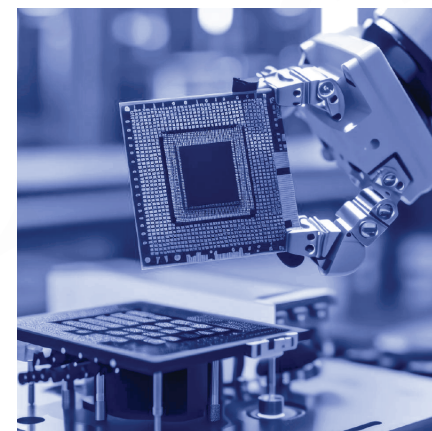


Semiconductors Have Become Strategic Infrastructure In The AI Economy

- Global AI infrastructure capex is projected to exceed **\$5.2 Tn by 2030**, shifting value upstream to chip suppliers
- AI accelerator markets alone could surpass **\$500 Bn by 2028**
- By 2027–28, **70–80%** of devices (PCs, smartphones) are expected to embed AI-optimised processors
- Semiconductor supply, not software innovation, is now the primary bottleneck to AI growth

Global Supply Chains Are Fragile, Creating An Opportunity For India

- Taiwan produces **90%+ of advanced chips**, creating systemic geopolitical risk
- A major disruption could erase up to **\$10 Tn in global economic output**
- Governments and corporations are actively pursuing **“China+1” diversification strategies**
- Capital is shifting toward domestic or allied semiconductor ecosystems



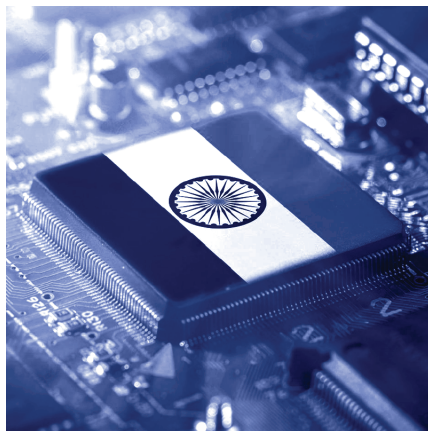
India's Semiconductor Market Is Scaling Rapidly, With Startup-Led Value Creation

- India's semiconductor market projected to grow from **\$62 Bn (2026) to ~\$155 Bn by 2031**
- Potential to account for **9–10% of global demand by decade's end**
- Domestic smartphone production has expanded **28X since FY15**
- **~20% of global iPhones are now assembled in India**

Talent Is India's Strongest Structural Advantage

- India hosts **~20% of the world's semiconductor design workforce**
- Produces **2–3 Mn STEM graduates annually**
- Global chipmakers increasingly rely on India for end-to-end design and R&D





Policy Is Shifting From Capacity Creation To Ecosystem Building

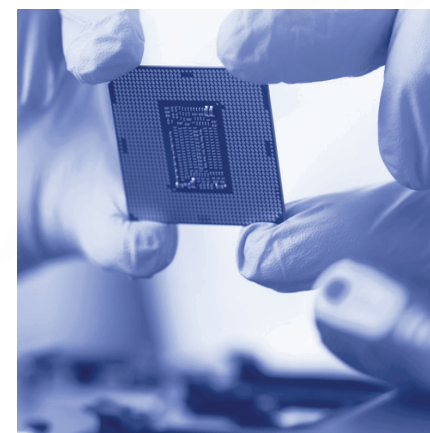
Key initiatives under ISM 1.0 → ISM 2.0 transition:

- ₹76,000 Cr initial semiconductor mission outlay
- Expanded support via ECMS and design incentives
- Up to **50% capital subsidy** for fabrication projects
- DLI schemes covering up to **50% of design costs**
- Programmes for tools access, prototyping and talent development

Global Capital Is Already Validating India's Position

Over \$15 Bn+ committed investments across the value chain, including:

- Tata-PSMC ~\$11 Bn fabrication project
- Micron ~\$2.75 Bn ATMP facility
- Large R&D expansions by NXP, AMD and others
- Growing partnerships with global leaders



AI And Data Infrastructure Are Driving Parallel Capital Deployment

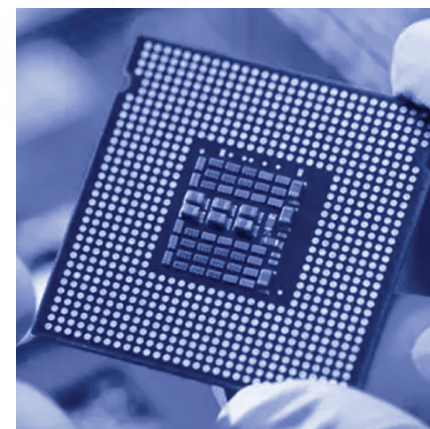
Recent announcements signal multi-layered investment:

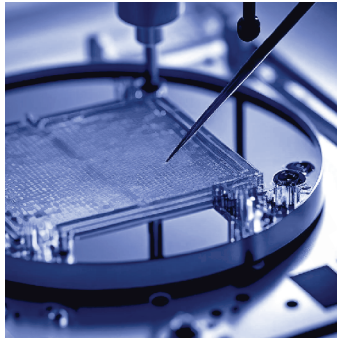
- **\$200 Bn+ expected in AI and deeptech investments** in the coming years
- Large commitments from Reliance, Adani, Microsoft and others
- Expansion of GPU capacity, data centres and compute infrastructure

India's Entry Strategy Focuses On Pragmatic Segments First

Rather than competing directly in advanced nodes, India's approach emphasises:

- Design & fabless development (immediate strength)
- ATMP/OSAT and advanced packaging (gateway manufacturing play)
- Mature-node fabs for automotive and industrial demand
- Long-term localisation of equipment and materials





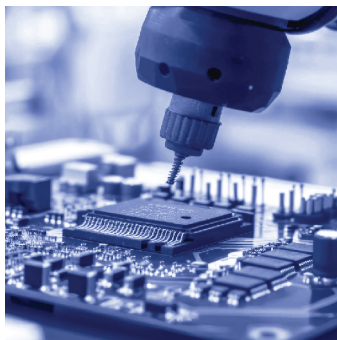
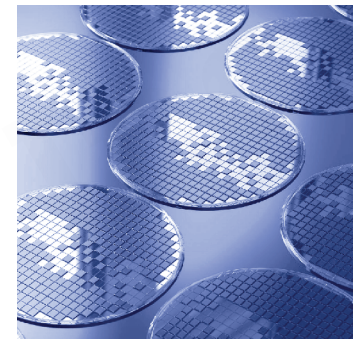
Startups Will Capture Disproportionate Value In Specific Segments

Most venture-backable opportunities lie outside capital-intensive fabs, in high-feasibility areas:

- Edge AI chips and domain-specific accelerators
- Analogue and mixed-signal ICs
- RISC-V architectures and custom IP
- EDA tools and semiconductor SaaS
- Packaging, testing and fab services

Import-substitution opportunities

- Power electronics for EVs and grid infrastructure
- Materials, chemicals and consumables (>90% import dependent)
- Defence and strategic electronics



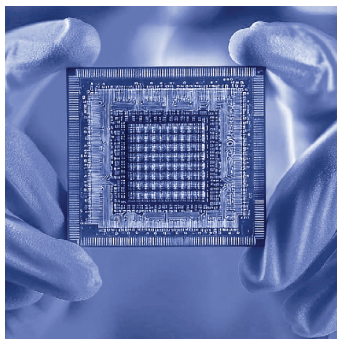
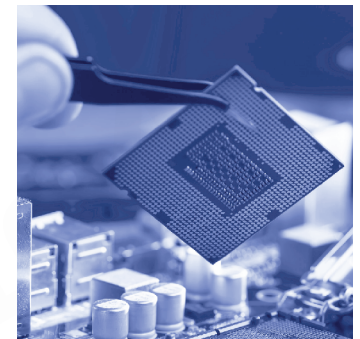
Capital And R&D Gaps Remain Critical Constraints

- India's R&D intensity ~0.6% of GDP — far below global leaders
- Needs \$100 Bn+ annual R&D spending by 2030 to compete
- Private sector contributes only ~41% of R&D funding
- 66% of investors cite capital constraints as the primary barrier to deeptech

Infrastructure And Supply Chain Weaknesses Must Be Addressed

Key structural gaps:

- Power and water reliability below mature hubs
- Heavy dependence on imported chemicals, equipment and materials
- Nascent domestic supplier ecosystem
- Risk of talent outflow to established semiconductor regions



Execution Speed Will Determine Outcomes

India's opportunity is real but time-bound:

- Early wins likely in mature nodes, analogue IP and packaging
- Startups must move rapidly from **design** → **validation** → **repeatable revenue**
- Global leadership requires eventual expansion into advanced technologies

Silicon Sovereignty Meets Startup Opportunity

India stands at the threshold of semiconductor sovereignty. As AI accelerates global demand for compute, global capital expenditure on AI related data centres is projected to **exceed \$5.2 Tn by 2030**, highlighting the scale and strategic urgency of the infrastructure race. Chips have become the foundational resource of the digital economy. In comparison, India's data centre investment is projected at **around \$30 Bn by 2030**, underscoring both the gap and the opportunity as the country builds its digital and semiconductor capabilities.

Yet the system that produces advanced chips remains dangerously concentrated. **Taiwan manufactures over 90% of the world's most advanced semiconductors**, making the global technology stack acutely vulnerable to geopolitical shocks. **A disruption in the Taiwan Strait could erase up to \$10 Tn in economic value, exposing how fragile today's supply chains truly are.**

For India, this fragility is an opening. The AI boom has transformed semiconductors into strategic infrastructure: the “new oil” powering everything from edge AI and 5G networks to electric vehicles and defence systems. In response, India has moved from being a design talent hub to pursuing full-stack capability through the India Semiconductor Mission.

ISM 1.0's ₹76,000 Cr foundation is now evolving into ISM 2.0, with expanded incentives such as the ₹40,000 Cr Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme. More importantly, global capital is already validating the shift: Micron's \$2.75 Bn ATMP facility, Tata-PSMC's \$11 Bn fabrication project, and NXP's \$1 Bn R&D expansion are part of over \$15 Bn in committed investments positioning India as a credible “China+1” manufacturing and innovation base.

India's semiconductor market is projected to grow from \$62 Bn in 2026 (5–6% of global share) to roughly \$155 Bn by 2031 (9–10%), creating an incremental value pool of about \$93 Bn.

Crucially, this expansion is not expected to be driven by large fabs alone. With nearly **20% of the world's semiconductor design workforce** and more than 100 active startups spanning fabless design, packaging, materials and equipment, the country's agility lies in its startup ecosystem. However, capital deployment remains far below what the sector demands, creating a funding gap that could determine whether this window translates into leadership or dependency.

This report examines where value will accrue across India's semiconductor stack and where startups can realistically win, particularly in segments such as edge AI accelerators, automotive and EV power electronics, 5G/RF components, and analogue chips, where development cycles are shorter and domestic demand is strong. It also analyses the enabling role of policy instruments like the Design Linked Incentive scheme, which can offset up to 50% of design costs, and the structural challenges, from foundry access to talent competition, that will shape outcomes over the next decade.

The foundations are being laid, global supply chains are actively diversifying, and domestic demand is accelerating. The decisive question is whether founders, investors and industry leaders can execute fast enough to convert this geopolitical opportunity into enduring industrial capability

Semiconductors Are At The 'Heart' Of Global AI Upsurge

The **release of ChatGPT** in November 2022 marked a structural shift in the technology landscape. **AI moved from research labs into everyday workflows almost overnight**, triggering an arms race among technology companies, enterprises and governments to build AI-native products.

Unlike previous software-driven cycles, generative AI requires massive computational power to train and deploy models at scale. This demand spans hyperscale data centres, enterprise infrastructure and, increasingly, consumer devices.

What makes this cycle different is the mismatch between demand velocity and supply lead times: AI workloads are scaling exponentially, while chips, high-bandwidth memory and advanced packaging capacity take years to build.

As organisations move AI from experimentation to production, access to specialised chips: GPUs, accelerators, high-bandwidth memory and power-efficient processors, has become the primary constraint.

This surge in compute demand is reshaping global investment patterns. **Cloud providers are committing trillions to AI-ready infrastructure**, device makers are embedding on-device intelligence, and enterprises are redesigning technology stacks around AI workloads.

In effect, semiconductors have shifted from invisible components to the central infrastructure powering the AI economy..

\$5.2Tn

Projected Global Data Centre
Capex Required To Support
AI Workloads By 2030

\$500 Bn+

Estimated Global Market For AI
Accelerator Chips By 2028

80%

PCs Expected To Incorporate
AI-Optimised Processors By
2027

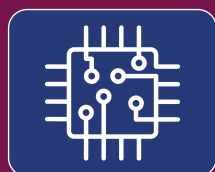
70%

Smartphones Projected To
Ship With AI-Specific Chips By
2028

Why Chips Suddenly Matter



AI demand is scaling faster
than supply can respond



Advanced chips and packaging
take years to build



Compute capacity now
determines technological
power



Control over chips shapes
economic and security
outcomes

Semiconductor Stocks Emerge As Clear Winners In AI Rally

Semiconductor Stocks Have Outpaced All Sectors Since ChatGPT's Launch



Post-ChatGPT's November 2022 launch, semiconductor stocks have delivered a decisive breakaway — rising 700%+ by 2026, far ahead of other major sectors (most below 200%). The market is signalling a structural truth: in an AI cycle, value accrues first to the layer that supplies compute.

This is not simply a tech rally. It reflects a shift in how investors price the AI economy, from software-led narratives to hardware-led constraints. GPUs, accelerators, high-bandwidth memory and advanced packaging have become the hard bottlenecks behind model training and inference at scale.

The implication is clear: semiconductors are being re-rated from cyclical components to strategic infrastructure.

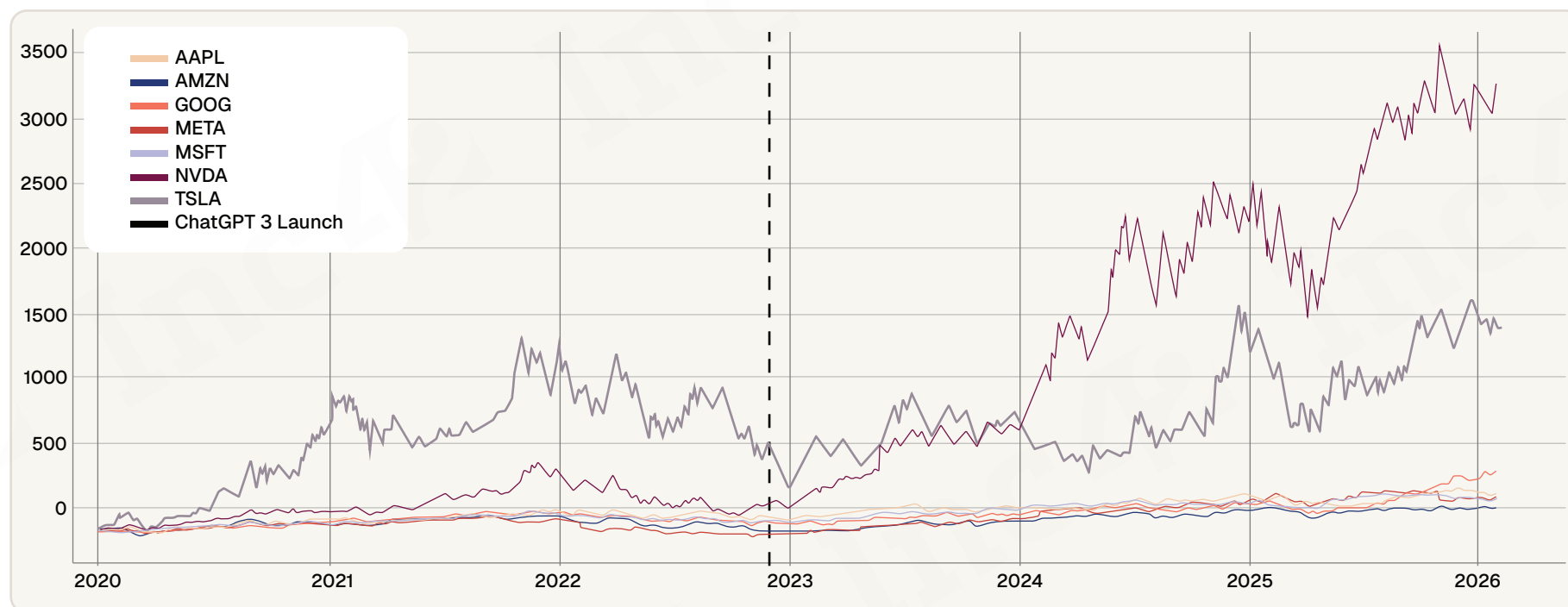
- ✳ For AI-first companies, access to compute is now a competitiveness issue.
- ✳ For governments, it is increasingly a sovereignty issue.
- ✳ And for supply chains, it is a resilience issue.

In effect: the AI boom is reshaping global capital and industrial policy around semiconductors.

The Market Signal

- ✳ AI value creation is flowing upstream to compute providers
- ✳ Semiconductor supply (chips + HBM + packaging) is now the limiting factor
- ✳ Markets are treating semiconductors as critical infrastructure, not commodities

NVIDIA Becomes The Magnificent Seven's Standout Winner In AI



NVIDIA's performance since late 2022 illustrates how decisively the AI boom has shifted value toward semiconductor leaders. While other members of the "Magnificent Seven" have benefited from AI enthusiasm, NVIDIA's growth has been orders of magnitude higher.

NVIDIA is the only company in the group whose core business is supplying the high-performance chips required to train and run advanced AI models. As demand for GPUs and accelerators surged, the company effectively became the gatekeeper of large-scale AI compute.

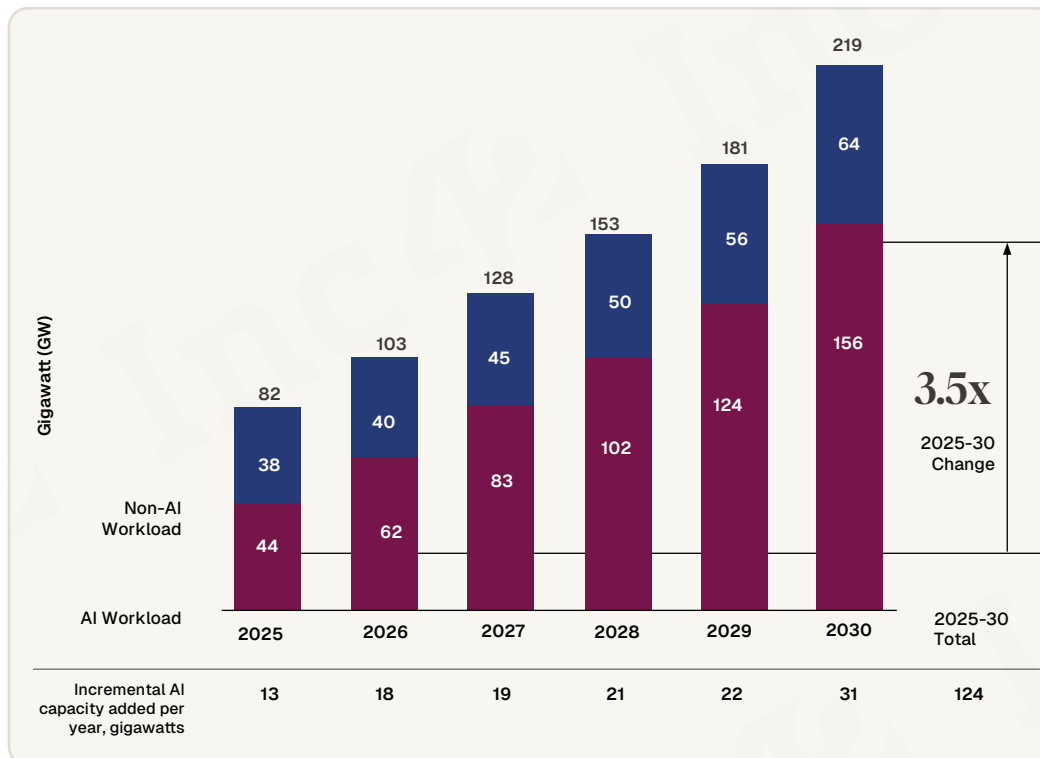
This divergence highlights a broader market reality: AI adoption across industries depends on semiconductor capacity. Software platforms, cloud providers and device manufacturers all rely on the same upstream hardware foundation.

In effect, NVIDIA's dominance reflects the central role of semiconductors as the primary enabler and constraint of the AI economy.

The Bottom Line

- ★ AI value creation is concentrating in companies that control compute
- ★ Semiconductor supply, not software innovation, is the primary bottleneck
- ★ Access to advanced GPUs now determines AI competitiveness

AI Will Drive Over 70% Of Global Data Centre Compute Demand By 2030



Unlike traditional IT demand, AI requires specialised hardware: high-performance GPUs, advanced packaging, high-bandwidth memory, and energy-intensive cooling systems.

Control over semiconductor supply chains will increasingly determine technological leadership, economic competitiveness, and national security.

Governments are responding with large-scale industrial policy. **The US CHIPS Act, EU Chips Act, China's integrated circuit fund, and India's semiconductor mission collectively represent hundreds of billions of dollars in public investment** aimed at building domestic capabilities from design to fabrication.

However, supply remains highly concentrated. **Taiwan manufactures the vast majority of advanced chips**, creating systemic vulnerability. Any disruption, geopolitical conflict, export controls, or supply bottlenecks could slow AI deployment globally.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, KPMG

The Price Of AI Compute



\$6.7 Tn

Estimated global investment required



\$5.2 Tn

AI-optimised infrastructure (GPUs, specialised cooling, advanced systems)



\$1.5 Tn

Traditional IT infrastructure (cloud, storage, enterprise systems)

AI-ready data centres require ~3.5x higher capital intensity than conventional facilities, reflecting the shift toward power-dense compute environments.

The Bottom Line

- AI demand is shifting the world from software scarcity to compute scarcity
- Semiconductor supply will become a bottleneck for AI growth
- Nations are moving from digital policy to industrial policy
- Supply concentration introduces systemic geopolitical risk

Semiconductor Supply Chains Face Disruption Risk Due To High Regional Concentration

Supply Side

Taiwan manufactures over 90% of advanced semiconductors

Taiwan accounts for 60%+ of global foundry revenues

7 of the top 10 foundries are based in Taiwan or China

The United States dominates fabless design and IP, generating over 60% of global revenue in this segment

China controls most critical raw materials essential for semiconductor manufacturing

Demand Side

China is the largest chip market, consuming nearly one-third of global output

NVIDIA alone represents a dominant share of AI-driven demand

US-based companies control over 50% of global semiconductor revenues

The US & China together purchase roughly 60% of Taiwan's exports

The US hosts about 45% of global data centre capacity, driving high-end chip consumption

Global semiconductor manufacturing is concentrated in a handful of regions. Taiwan produces most advanced chips, while South Korea, Japan, and the United States dominate key segments of the value chain. This geographic concentration creates systemic vulnerability.

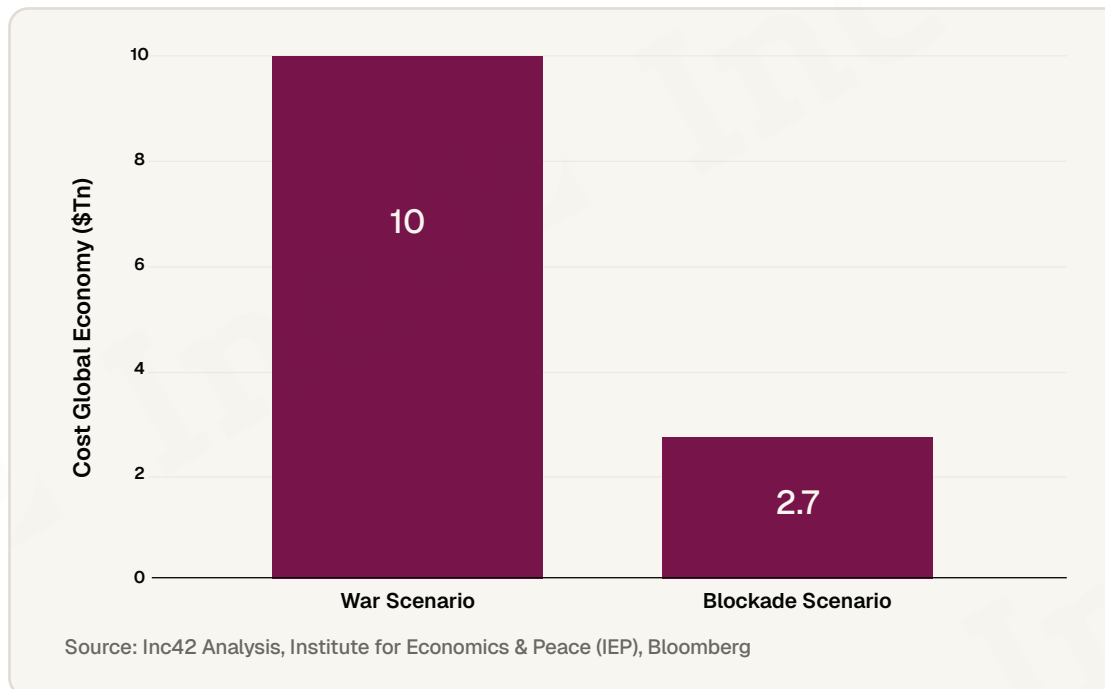
Disruption in a single region — whether due to conflict, natural disasters or trade restrictions — can halt production across industries worldwide.

Recent events, including pandemic-era shortages, have demonstrated how fragile semiconductor supply chains can be.

As chips underpin everything from smartphones to defence systems, supply resilience has become a strategic priority for governments and corporations alike.

A geographically concentrated supply chain creates systemic chokepoints, where disruption in a single region can halt production worldwide, making semiconductors a systemic economic risk rather than a sector-specific issue.

A China–Taiwan Conflict Could Trigger A \$10 Tn Global Economic Shock



Why This Matters For India



Global buyers are actively seeking alternatives to Taiwan-centric supply chains



Semiconductor capacity is becoming a geopolitical asset, not just industrial output



India's market scale + talent pool make it a prime diversification candidate

A full-scale China–Taiwan conflict could wipe out ~\$10 Tn of global output (9–10% of GDP), exceeding the combined impact of the 2008 financial crisis and COVID-19. Even a limited blockade could trigger losses of ~\$2.7 Tn, underscoring Taiwan's systemic importance to the world economy.

With Taiwan producing the majority of advanced chips, supply disruptions could halt production across automotive, electronics, telecom, defence and healthcare within months.

In a global economy where industries operate on precarious 3-to-6-month chip buffers, even a minor supply chain tremor triggers a catastrophic cascade of factory halts and stalled innovation. In this era of 'supply chain hardening,' diversification has transitioned from a strategic preference to a survival mandate.

As nations race to decouple from high-risk geographic bottlenecks, India has emerged as a critical second-source pillar—leveraging its Semiconductor Mission 2.0 and the launch of commercial production at sites like Micron's Sanand facility to mitigate single-point-of-failure risks and anchor the next generation of global electronics.

India's semiconductor push positions it as a potential stabiliser in a fragmented supply chain. A credible domestic ecosystem could capture a meaningful share of future production while enhancing global resilience.

Source: Institute for Economics and Peace, Inc42 Analysis

Global Capital Is Shifting Toward Domestic Semiconductor Supply Chains

As the risks of geographic concentration become untenable, the flight of capital from cross-border exposure is driving a structural pivot toward domestic industrial sovereignty. The collision of heightened geopolitical volatility and a regime shift in global bond markets marks the definitive end of the hyper-globalisation era, ushering in a more fragmented, multipolar economic order.

The BlackRock Geopolitical Risk Score and sovereign bond markets point to the same structural shift: the era of hyper-globalisation and cheap capital is fading.

Repeated geopolitical shocks are no longer treated as temporary volatility, they are being priced into long-term risk assessments and financing costs.

Rising yields across major economies signal that the cost of capital has moved structurally higher, particularly in Western markets. Together, these indicators show that investors are repricing geopolitical risk, not merely reacting to isolated events.

Geopolitical risks are driving a 'home bias,' as investors retreat to domestic assets amid sanctions, freezes, trade restrictions, and policy uncertainty

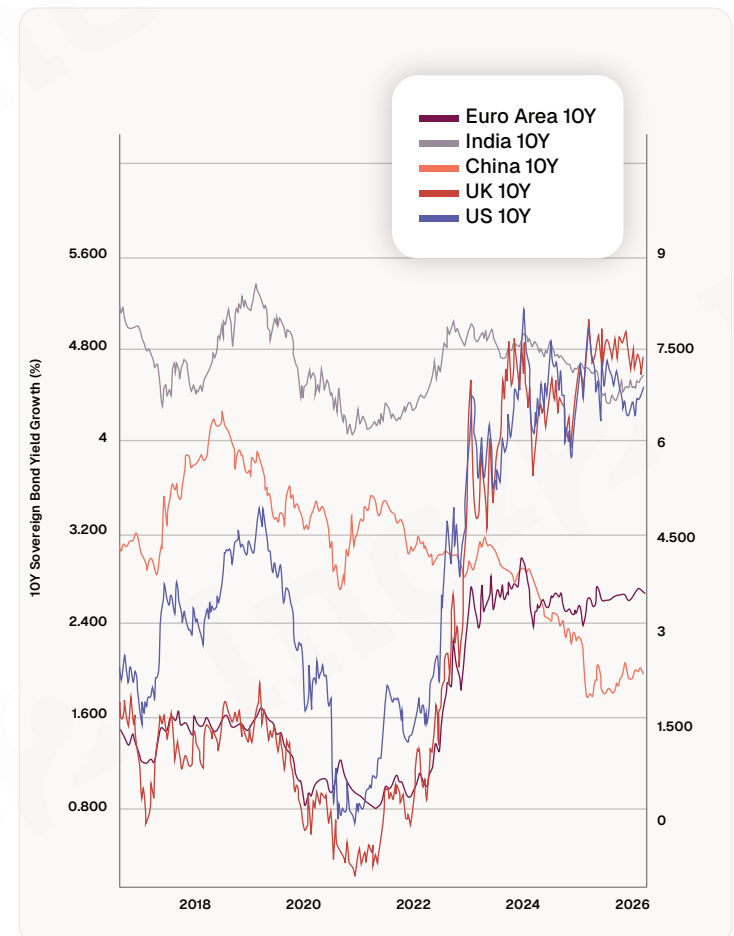
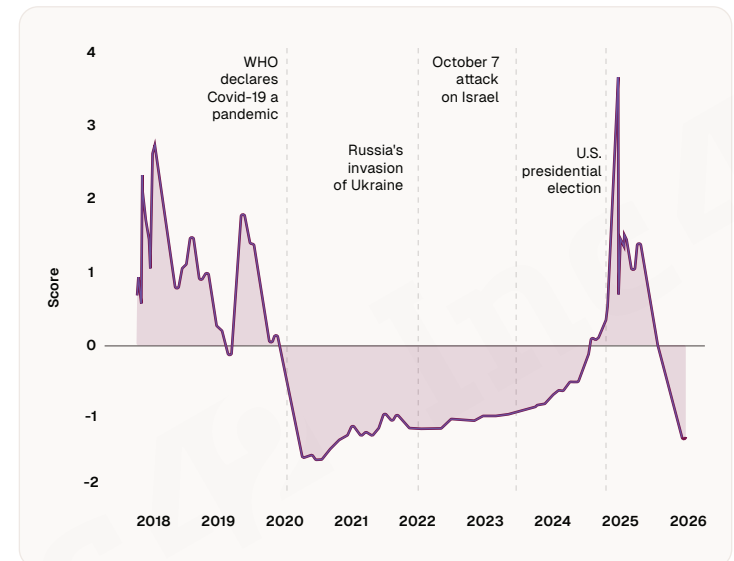
Semiconductors sit at the centre of this transition because they are both strategic and capital-intensive. Building fabs, packaging facilities and upstream material ecosystems requires long-term financing, policy stability and supply-chain security.

As capital becomes more expensive and more national, large-scale manufacturing is increasingly anchored within domestic or regional blocs rather than global networks.

In short: the world is shifting from efficiency-driven globalisation to security-driven localisation.

Why This Matters For Strategic Industries

- Large industrial projects depend on long-term capital
- Domestic financing is becoming more critical
- Cross-border manufacturing is increasingly risky
- Supply chains are reorganising around geopolitical blocs

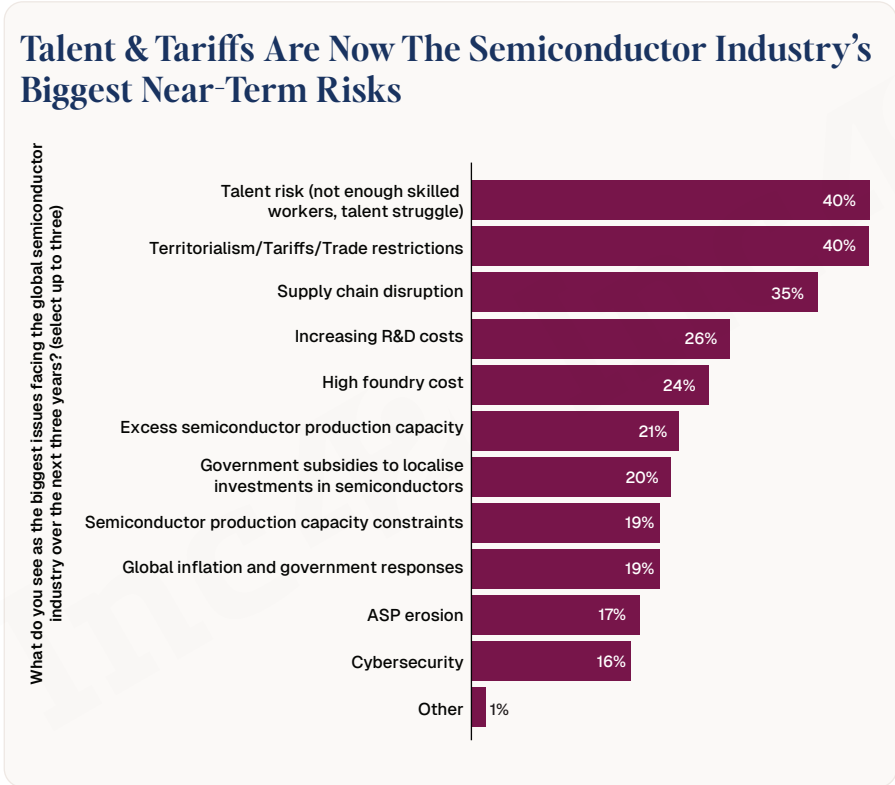
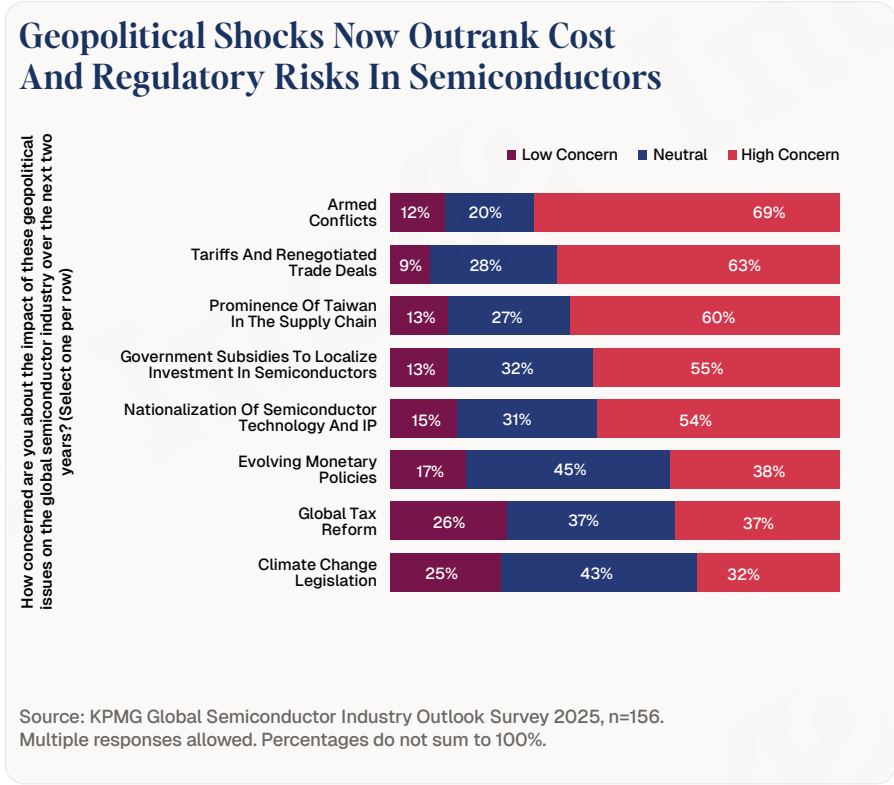


Note: Chart 1: Tracks the BlackRock Global Trade Protectionism Score, illustrating the cyclical volatility of geopolitical risk and its sharp correction entering 2026.

Chart 2: Compares 10-year sovereign bond yields across major economies, highlighting the structural divergence between rising Western borrowing costs and China's declining rates.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, Blackrock, Trading Economics

Geopolitical Risks Now Dominate Semiconductor Industry Priorities



The Semiconductor C-Suite Is Now Pricing In Geopolitical Risk: The data signals a clear shift in executive priorities across the semiconductor industry. Traditional concerns such as inflation, R&D costs and taxation are being overtaken by geopolitical threats, pushing the sector from efficiency-led optimisation to resilience-led strategy.

From “Green Premium” To “Geopolitical Premium”: This reordering matters because it changes how companies plan and price risk. For many firms, ESG commitments and cost optimisation are being reprioritised behind supply continuity. Procurement leaders can no longer treat tariffs as a temporary disruption, they must be modelled as a structural component of COGS.

What the data says

69%

Of respondents cite armed conflicts as a high concern

63%

Flag tariffs and trade deals as a high concern

32%

Cite climate change legislation as a high concern

Taiwan Risk Remains Unresolved: Even after years of “China+1” strategy, concentration risk persists. The prominence of Taiwan in the semiconductor supply chain is a high concern for 60% of respondents, indicating that diversification is happening — but not fast enough to reduce anxiety at the board level.

The world is now searching for credible alternatives to concentrated semiconductor supply chains.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, KPMG

India Emerges As A Strategic Alternative In A Fragmenting Semiconductor World

Rising geopolitical tensions, export controls and supply chain disruptions are forcing governments and corporations to reduce dependence on concentrated semiconductor hubs and build more resilient production networks.

In this global search for alternatives, India is emerging as one of the most credible long-term destinations.

The country combines a large domestic electronics market, a deep engineering talent base and growing alignment with major technology economies. Rather than attempting complete self-sufficiency, India is positioning itself as an indispensable node within diversified, allied supply chains.

Policy support has accelerated this shift. Through the India Semiconductor Mission, production-linked incentives and capital subsidies, the government is actively building an end-to-end ecosystem spanning design, manufacturing, packaging and testing.

Global manufacturers and technology firms have begun committing capital, signalling confidence in India's ability to scale production while reducing geopolitical exposure.

As companies prioritise resilience over efficiency, India stands out as one of the few economies capable of supporting semiconductor manufacturing at meaningful scale.

Key Statistics That Show India Is Ready For Advanced Tech Manufacturing & Exports

\$24 Bn

Smartphone Exports (55% YoY Growth), Signalling Rising Manufacturing Scale

~20%

Of The World's Semiconductor Design Engineers Are Based In India

\$10 Bn+

Government Commitment To Semiconductor Development

2-3 Mn

STEM Graduates Annually, Among The Largest Talent Pipelines Globally

100%

FDI Permitted Under Automatic Route For Most Semiconductor Segments

Up To 50%

Capital Subsidy For Fabrication Projects

~10%

Potential Global Market Share By 2030 Under Successful Execution Scenarios

Why India Is Gaining Strategic Importance



Diversification Pull

"China+1" has moved from strategy to execution across electronics and semiconductors



Domestic Demand

EVs, telecom/5G, consumer electronics, defence and data centres create a real proving ground



Talent Advantage

India's design base enables movement up the value chain, not just assembly



Policy Backing

Long-horizon incentives reduce capital risk and accelerate ecosystem formation



Anchor Investments

Large projects create clustering effects for suppliers, startups and services

India's Semiconductor Readiness: The Four Pillars

India's semiconductor ambitions are no longer driven by policy intent alone. A combination of structural demand, talent depth, capital commitments and industrial policy is converging to create the minimum conditions required for a scalable domestic ecosystem.

Unlike earlier attempts that focused on isolated fabrication projects, the current push reflects a broader shift toward building an integrated value chain capable of supporting both domestic consumption and export markets.

Demand At Scale: A Built-In Market

India's expanding electronics base provides immediate and sustained chip demand across multiple sectors.

- ✦ Rapid growth in smartphones, EVs, telecom infrastructure and data centres
- ✦ Industrial automation and defence modernisation creating specialised needs
- ✦ Domestic consumption reduces reliance on export markets for early scale
- ✦ Large market improves viability of manufacturing investments

“Few emerging economies can combine manufacturing ambition with such a large internal demand base.

Talent Advantage: Design Strength At Global Scale

India hosts one of the world's deepest semiconductor engineering pools, particularly in chip design and embedded systems.

- ✦ ~20% of global semiconductor design workforce based in India
- ✦ Strong presence of global R&D centres across major chipmakers
- ✦ Large annual pipeline of STEM graduates
- ✦ Experience across full product lifecycles through multinational exposure

“This talent base enables India to compete in design-led segments without matching manufacturing scale immediately.

Policy & Institutional Support: Long-Term Visibility

Government programmes are reducing capital risk and signalling commitment to sustained ecosystem development.

- ✦ India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) providing multi-year incentives
- ✦ Capital subsidies covering up to ~50% of project costs in some cases
- ✦ Design Linked Incentive (DLI) schemes supporting fabless startups
- ✦ Infrastructure, training and supply-chain initiatives expanding under ISM 2.0

“Policy continuity is critical for an industry with decade-long investment cycles.

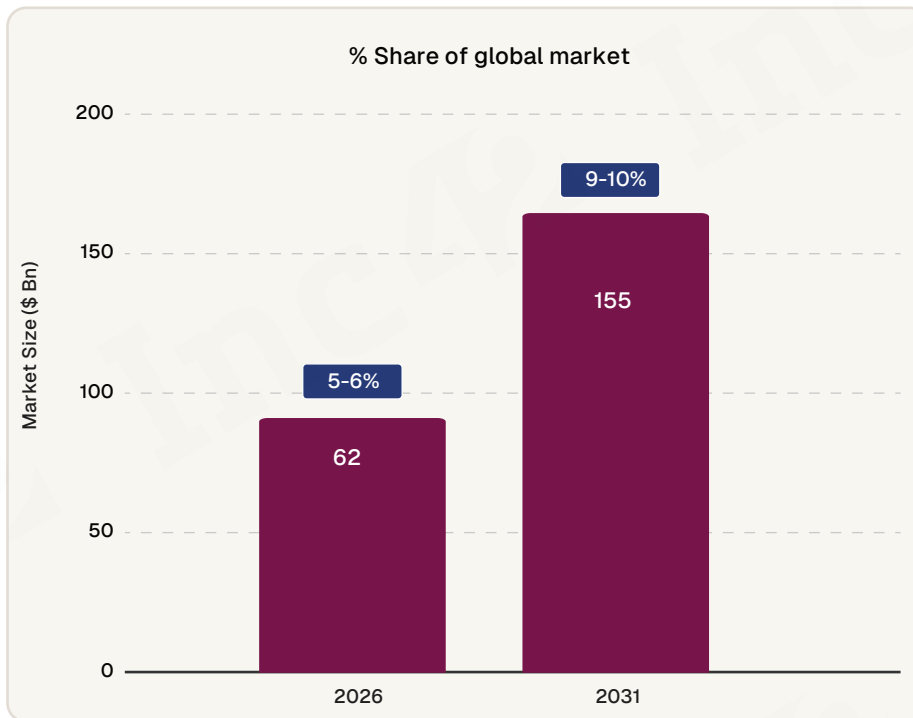
Anchor Investments & Ecosystem Formation

Large global and domestic projects are creating the industrial base around which smaller firms can scale.

- ✦ Fabrication, ATMP and R&D investments from global leaders
- ✦ Partnerships bringing technology transfer and operational expertise
- ✦ Early supplier ecosystems forming around anchor facilities
- ✦ Signals to global capital that India is transitioning from intent to execution

“Semiconductor ecosystems rarely emerge organically — anchor projects catalyse clustering effects.

India's Share In The Global Semiconductor Market Is On The Rise



The global semiconductor market is expected to nearly double to about **\$1.8 Tn by 2031**, driven by AI, electrification and digital infrastructure.

India's expanding economy, large consumer base and rising industrial demand place it among the few markets capable of sustaining large-scale semiconductor growth.

Over the past decade, India has built a strong foundation in electronics manufacturing. Domestic production of mobile phones has increased 28-fold between FY15 and FY25, reflecting rapid industrial capability expansion.

India is also becoming increasingly integrated into global supply chains. Notably, around 20% of the world's iPhones are now manufactured in India, signalling growing confidence among global technology firms.

Beyond manufacturing, India's strengths in semiconductor design remain critical.

With nearly 20% of the global chip design workforce, the country is transitioning from a back-office engineering hub to a potential originator of indigenous IP for emerging applications such as 5G, electric vehicles, power electronics and edge AI.

Why This Growth Matters



Manufacturing scale supports downstream chip demand



Design talent enables movement up the value chain



Domestic use cases create sustainable market pull



Transition underway from executing global designs to developing indigenous IP



Strong potential in sectors such as 5G infrastructure, EV power electronics and edge AI

In essence, India is evolving from a design services hub into a full-stack semiconductor participant.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, IESA, McKinsey

Note: India's semiconductor market size is benchmarked to the

latest IESA base-year estimate, with projections adjusted to reflect the incremental impact of Union Budget 2026 incentives and policy announcements

India Is Emerging As The Challenger In The Global Semiconductor Power Structure

Parameter	United States (The Architect)	China (The Scale Player)	India (The Rising Challenger)
 Primary Strength	R&D and Chip Design. Home to giants like Nvidia, AMD, and Intel.	Legacy Node Dominance. Largest producer of 28 nm+ "foundational" chips.	Chip Design Talent. Houses 20% of global semiconductor design engineers.
 Manufacturing Focus	Leading-Edge (<5nm). Aggressive push to reshore 2nm/3nm logic via CHIPS Act.	Self-Sufficiency. Massive investment in mature nodes to bypass Western sanctions.	ATMP & Mature Nodes. Focused on Assembly, Testing (OSAT), and 28nm-40nm nodes.
 Key Policy	CHIPS & Science Act. Over \$52 Bn in direct subsidies and R&D.	Big Fund Phase III. ~\$47-49 Bn fund to drive indigenous tech breakthroughs.	ISM 2.0 (2026). Recalibrated focus on full stack capabilities including: raw material, IP and manufacturing.
 Supply Chain Role	Equipment & Software. Controls EDA tools and key manufacturing IP.	Raw Materials. Dominates global supply of Gallium, Germanium, and Graphite.	Testing & Packaging. Emerging as a global "back-end" hub to diversify from China.
 Biggest Hurdle	Cost of Operations. High labor/construction costs for fabs compared to Asia.	Export Restrictions. Lack of access to advanced EUV lithography machines (ASML).	Infrastructure Readiness. Reliable power, water, and "fab-ready" logistics are still scaling.
 2026 Outlook	Sustaining AI leadership while fighting "brain drain" to startups.	Rapidly hitting 30%+ self-sufficiency in domestic chip consumption.	Moving from " policy stage " to " production stage " with first indigenous chip (180 nm) produced in 2025.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, Secondary Sources



**Shri
Narendra Modi**

Hon'ble Prime
Minister, India



“Today's India inspires confidence in the world... When the chips are down, you can bet on India”



**Jensen
Huang**

Founder & CEO, NVIDIA



“It makes complete sense that India should manufacture its own AI...India's technical talent is unmatched”



Dr. Lisa Su

Chair & CEO, AMD



“India is such an important part of AMD, when we look across all of our global portfolio, every aspect of our product line goes through our design centre here in India”

\$15 Bn+ In Strategic Semiconductor Investments Already Committed

Global semiconductor leaders — including Micron, Tata-PSMC, Applied Materials and Lam Research — have collectively committed over \$15 Bn to India, signalling a decisive shift in how supply chains are being redesigned for resilience rather than cost optimisation.

These investments span the full value chain:

Fabrication: Tata-PSMC's ~\$11 Bn fab project

Assembly & Testing (ATMP): Micron's ~\$2.75 Bn facility

Equipment & Engineering: Expansion of manufacturing tools, services and R&D capabilities

Evidence of readiness is already visible:

~20% of the world's iPhones are now assembled in India

\$24 Bn in annual smartphone exports

~20% of global semiconductor design talent located in the country

What This Unlocks For India's Ecosystem

Anchor demand for domestic suppliers across materials, chemicals and services

Faster commercialisation pathways for fabless and deep-tech startups

A foundation for repeat investments as production stabilises

As export controls, tariffs and geopolitical uncertainty become structural rather than temporary, global companies are building redundancy into critical supply chains. India is increasingly viewed as a scalable, politically stable alternative capable of supporting long-term capacity planning.

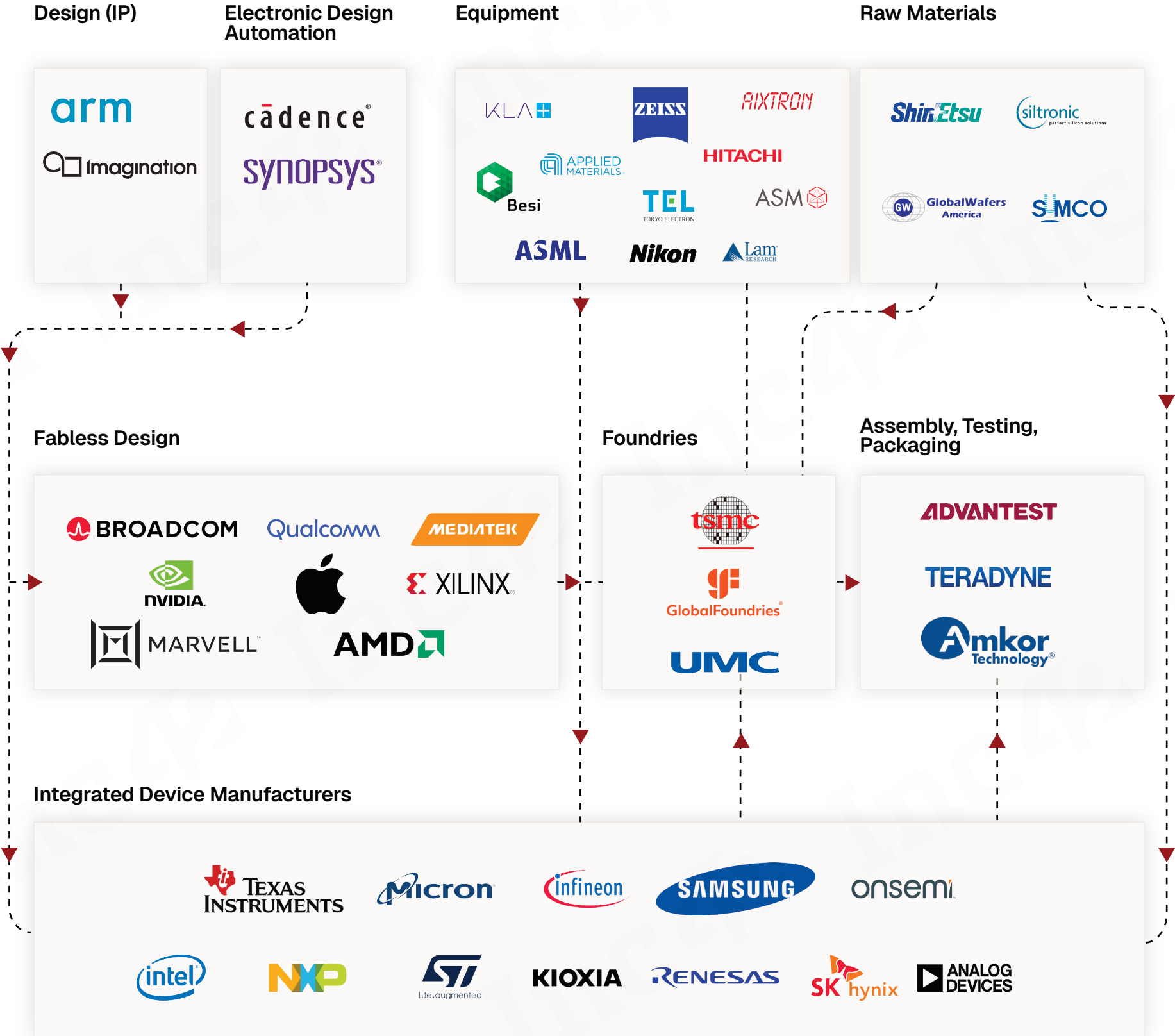


India's #1 Startup Intelligence Platform

Signals From News, Growth & People Moves — All In One View
With Verified Data And 30+ Advanced Filters — At A Tenth Of Legacy Costs.

A screenshot of the Inc42 Datalabs web application interface. The interface is divided into several sections. On the left, there is a sidebar with a 'Companies' header and an 'Advanced Filter' section. The 'Advanced Filter' section includes a 'Suggested Searches' dropdown and a list of filter options: 'Hot Funded Early Startups', 'Early Fundraisers', 'Startups Founded In 2025', 'Tier-1 Early Startups', and 'Solo-Founded Startups'. Below the filters, there is a 'Signals' section with a plus icon and an 'Overview' section. The main content area displays a list of startups. The first startup is 'SalezShark', which is highlighted with a red circle. The details for 'SalezShark' include its logo, name, social media links (Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn), industry 'Enterprise Tech', founder 'Ajay Chauhan', founding year '2014', location 'Herndon', and a description 'SalezShark offers CRM solutions with sales and marketing auto'. Below the description, there is a table with funding information: 'Funding Stage: Seed', 'Total Funding: \$2.00 Mn+', and 'Last Funding: 2015/10/19'. The second startup is 'Codebrahma', with details including its logo, name, social media links, industry 'Enterprise Tech', founder 'Anand Narayan', founding year '2012', and a description 'Codebrahma technology ser'. Below the description, there is a table with company information: 'Company Type: Bootstrapped' and 'Employee Count: 9'. At the bottom of the interface, there is a red button with the text 'EXPLORE DATALABS'.

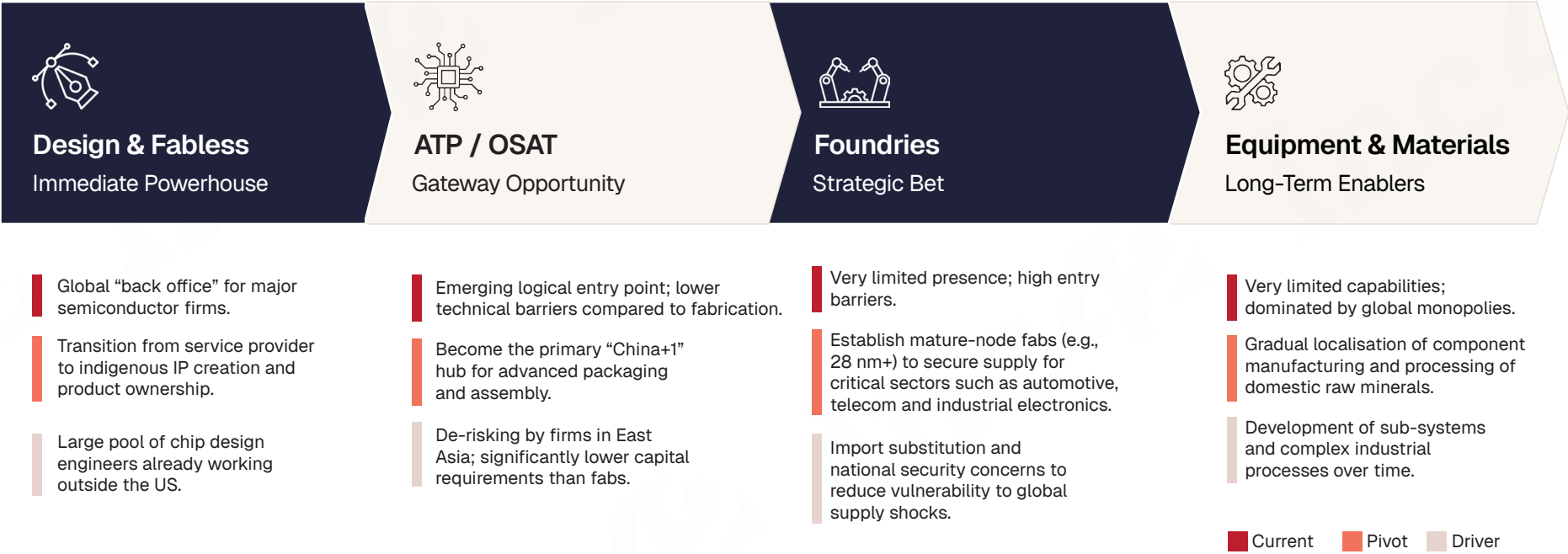
The Global Semiconductor Value Chain



Source: Quatr

India’s Strategic Entry Into The Global Semiconductor Value Chain

The Philosophy: Smart entry, not replication — leverage design talent, capture labour-intensive ATMP, subsidise mature fabs.

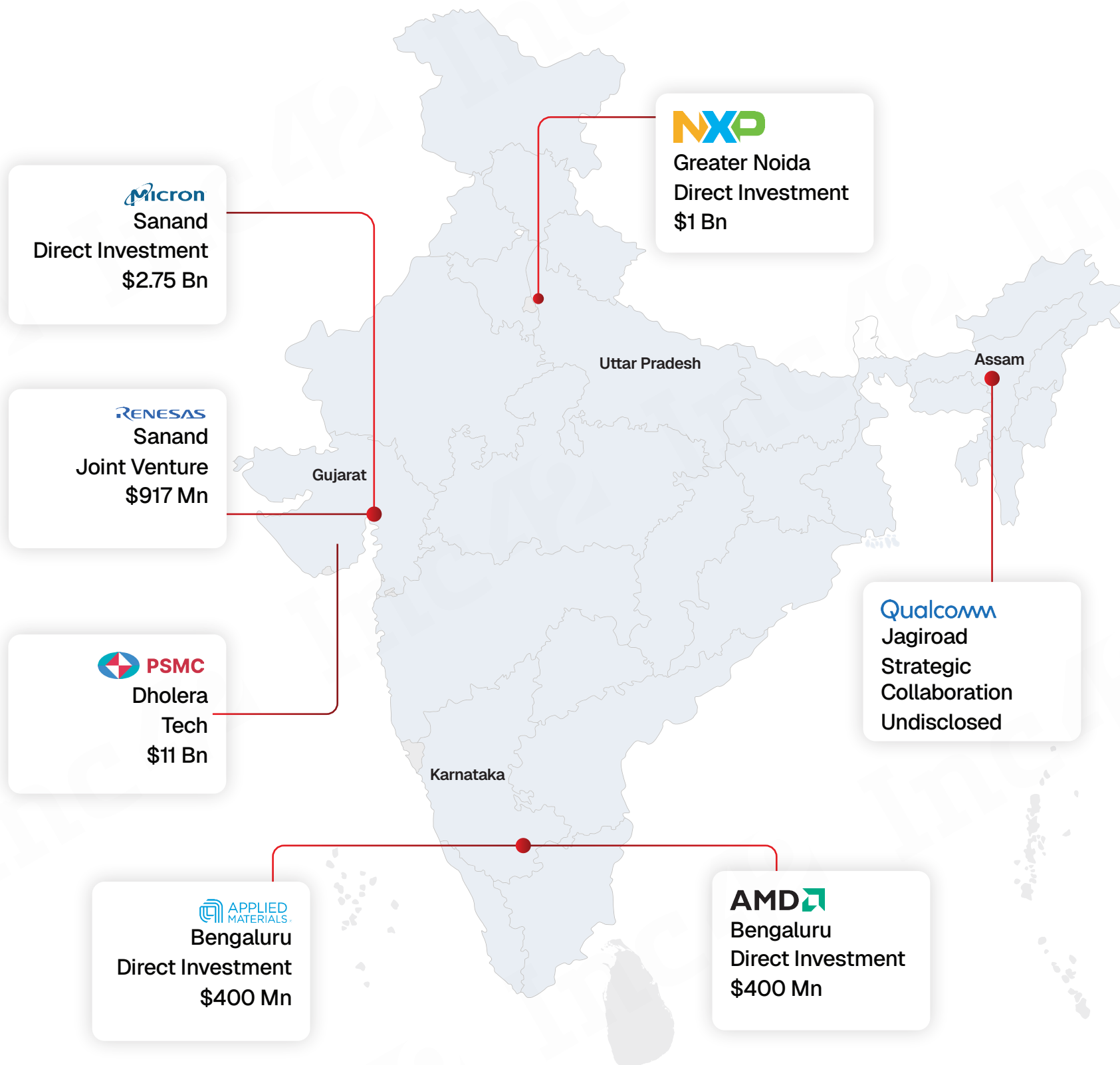


Timeline Of India’s Strategic Entry

	Immediate	Short-Term	Medium-Term	Long-Term
Value Chain Segment	Current Strength	India’s Pivotal Role Strategy	Time Horizon	
Design & Fabless	High (Services)	Shift to indigenous IP creation and product ownership	Immediate	
ATP / Packaging	High/Operational	Build the primary “China+1” hub for advanced packaging	Short-Term (3–5 Years)	
Foundries	Moderate/Building	Establish mature-node fabs for automotive resilience	Medium-Term (3–7 Years)	
Equipment & Materials	Nascent	Localise sub-components and process domestic raw minerals	Long-Term (7+ Years)	

Source: Inc42 Analysis

Who's Who In Global Semiconductors Is Already Betting On India



Source: Inc42 Analysis, Secondary Sources

Company	Headquarters	Entry Type	Investment	The India Advantage
	 USA	Direct Investment (Engineering I/R&D)	\$400 Mn (Engineering & collaborative semiconductor equipment development)	Co-Located Design-to-Validation Hub: By placing advanced testing infrastructure alongside its engineering centre in Bengaluru, Applied Materials can validate new tools locally rather than shipping prototypes overseas. This compresses development cycles, reduces costs, and positions India as a critical node in its global innovation pipeline
	 Japan	Joint Venture (CG Power & Stars Microelectronics)	\$917 Mn (ATMP / OSAT)	Future Demand Creation Strategy: Through partnerships, ecosystem programmes, and tool access initiatives, Renesas is embedding itself early in India's hardware startup and automotive ecosystem. By enabling local product development today, the company secures long-term demand as India scales EVs, smart infrastructure, and industrial electronics.
	 USA	Direct Investment (with Government Incentives)	\$2.75 Bn total project cost (~\$825 Mn Micron equity) (ATMP: DRAM & NAND modules)	Backend Manufacturing Anchor: Micron's ATMP facility establishes India as a major hub for memory packaging and testing, strengthening supply chain resilience outside East Asia. Government incentives reduce upfront capital burden while enabling Micron to secure early capacity in a large and rapidly growing electronics market.
	 Taiwan	Tech Licensing/Strategic Partnership (Tata Electronics)	\$11 Bn (Front-end Logic Fab)	Technology Transfer With Limited Capital Risk: Through a licensing-led partnership, PSMC gains access to India's market without building a standalone fabrication ecosystem from scratch. The arrangement provides Tata with mature-node manufacturing expertise while giving PSMC royalties and strategic positioning within India's domestic semiconductor push.

Company	Headquarters	Entry Type	Investment	The India Advantage
	 USA	Direct Investment	\$1 Bn (Expanding R&D activities in India)	Full-Stack R&D Ownership: NXP is shifting from using India purely for backend engineering to co-developing complex automotive and industrial chips locally. Leveraging India's deep design talent pool, the company gains scalable R&D capacity for next-generation systems that are increasingly software-defined and integration-heavy.
	 USA	Direct Investment	\$400 Mn (R&D Design Expansion)	Largest Global Design Base: AMD's consolidated engineering presence in Bengaluru enables tightly integrated development across CPUs, GPUs, AI accelerators, and graphics. Co-locating cross-functional teams accelerates complex chip design cycles and supports advanced packaging architectures that require close coordination across domains.
	 USA	Strategic Collaboration (Tata Electronics)	Undisclosed (Automotive Modules)	Strategic IP Development Hub: Aligned with India's Make in India initiative, Qualcomm Technologies will produce its Automotive Module products at Tata Electronics' upcoming OSAT facility in Jagiroad. The partnership will localize manufacturing of digital cockpit, infotainment, connectivity, and intelligent vehicle technologies—meeting rising demand from Indian and global automakers while strengthening supply chain

Source: Inc42 Analysis, Secondary Sources

India's AI Impact Summit Sparks Momentum In Chips, Compute, And Investment

The AI Impact Summit in February 2026 positioned India as a leader in AI development and adoption among the Global South. The announcements made during and around the event underscored a cohesive drive to advance localised AI infrastructure.

\$200 Bn+ Pledged for AI Data Centers Signal Domestic Chip Demand

- Reliance Industries:** Committed to investing approximately \$110 Bn over the next seven years to fund multi-gigawatt-scale AI-ready data centres, a nationwide edge computing network, and integrated AI services for the Jio ecosystem.
- Adani Group:** Announced a \$100 Bn investment to build a renewable-powered, AI-ready data centre platform by 2035, aiming to create a \$250 Bn AI infrastructure ecosystem over the next decade.
- Yotta Data Services:** Spending over \$2 Bn on Nvidia's latest chips to establish an AI computing hub, providing a major boost to local semiconductor demand and India's AI drive.

\$155 Bn+ Semiconductor Market Gets Local & Global Push

- Qualcomm's 2nm R&D Breakthrough:** Successfully tapped out an advanced 2nm chip design driven heavily by India-based engineering teams, demonstrating the market's graduation from basic back-office support to cutting-edge core IP creation.
- Upstream De-Risking via Foxconn-HCL JV & Rare Earth Corridors:** Alongside the recent groundbreaking of the Foxconn-HCL semiconductor plant in Jewar, UP, the government announced the development of dedicated "rare earth corridors." This parallel strategy ensures domestic fabs have uninterrupted access to the critical minerals required for advanced chipmaking.

Global Partnerships Deepen India's AI & Semiconductor Ecosystem

- Pax Silica Integration:** India has joined this U.S.-led international initiative and economic security framework, launched in December 2025, to secure the global supply chain for semiconductors and AI infrastructure.
- The AMD-TCS "Helios" Platform:** Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) and Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) are co-developing "Helios," a rack-scale AI infrastructure blueprint designed specifically for India's national AI initiatives to accelerate high-density compute deployment.
- L&T & NVIDIA Gigawatt Factory:** Larsen & Toubro (L&T) partnered with NVIDIA to build India's largest gigawatt-scale AI factory, deploying massive GPU and CPU clusters to ensure sovereign models and data can be created within India.

Indian Semiconductor Mission Is Rewriting India’s Role In The Global Chip Value Chain

The **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** was launched in **2021 under MeitY** to reduce India’s reliance on imports and build domestic capability across semiconductors and displays. With an initial outlay of **₹76,000 Cr (~\$10 Bn)**, **ISM 1.0** was designed as a capacity-building phase focused on getting large, anchor projects approved and into execution.

ISM 2.0 now signals a shift from “getting fabs started” to building a **full-stack ecosystem** — including components, materials, equipment, talent, and policy certainty.

ISM 1.0 Set The Foundation

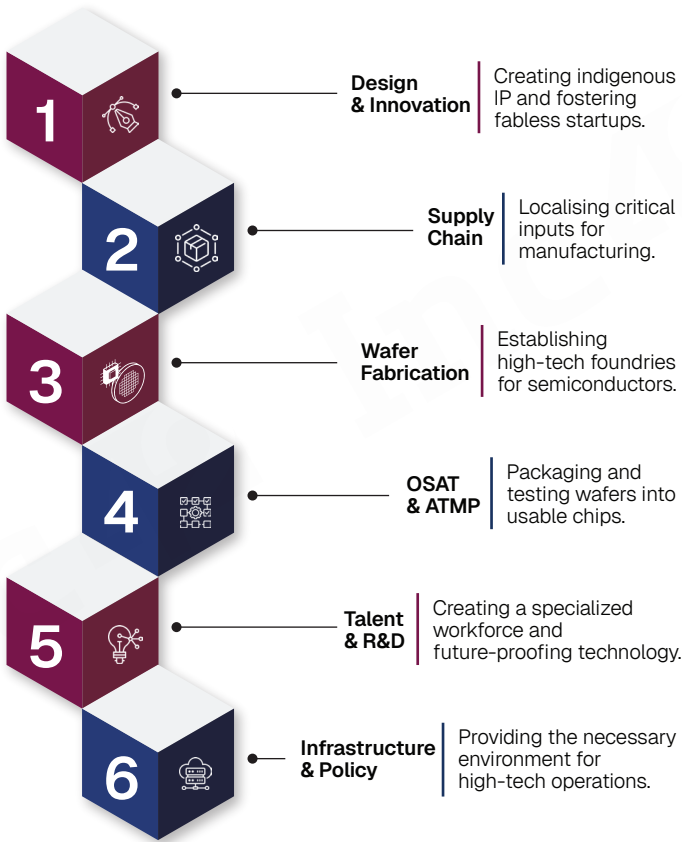
- ✦ **Focus:** Kick-start domestic capacity through anchor manufacturing and OSAT/ATMP projects
- ✦ **Progress marker:** Major approvals including the Tata-PSMC fab in Dholera and multiple OSAT/ATMP proposals
- ✦ **Outcome:** The programme moved from intent to execution by committing a large share of its outlay to on-ground projects

ISM 2.0 Expands The Stack

ISM 2.0 Lever	What It Changes
Full-Stack Capability Push	Extends focus beyond fabs to strengthen equipment, materials, packaging, and supply chain depth
ECMS Scaled Up	Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS) nearly doubled to ₹40,000 Cr
R&D + Talent Ramp-Up	Increased emphasis on research and training centres to build specialised semiconductor talent
Tax Certainty For Design-Led Businesses	Safe harbour thresholds for IT/ITeS (incl. design services) raised from ₹300 Cr to ₹2,000 Cr, reducing transfer-pricing friction
Critical Minerals Infrastructure	Rare Earth Corridors to secure inputs needed for chip production

ISM 1.0 created the manufacturing base; ISM 2.0 is designed to make it sustainable by building the full-stack ecosystem around it.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, PIB



Indian Semiconductor Mission 2.0 Aligns Policy, Capital & Talent For Full-Stack Scale

Indian Semiconductor Mission 2.0 signals India's move from "build plants" to "build capability". For stakeholders, the opportunity now widens from capacity creation to IP, materials, tools and talent, the layers that compound long-term advantage

Global & Domestic Giants



Vertical Integration Incentives

The expansion of **ECMS** and the launch of **ISM 2.0** prioritise the manufacturing of **upstream capital equipment and specialty chemicals**. For giants like Tata Electronics or Micron, this reduces the "Import-Intensity" of their local operations, mitigating global supply chain shocks.



Data Centre Expansion Push

To position India as a global cloud computing hub, Budget 2026-27 introduced a **tax holiday until 2047 for foreign companies providing global cloud services via Indian data centers**. It also introduced a safe harbor margin of 15% to simplify taxation for related entities.



Strategic Sourcing Of Critical Minerals:

The establishment of Dedicated Rare Earth Corridors and the removal of Basic Customs Duty (BCD) on **25 critical minerals (Lithium, Cobalt, Germanium)** create a cost-competitive base for high-purity inorganic material production, essential for advanced node fabrication.

Startup Founders



Extended Runway For Deeptech

Recognising the long gestation periods of chip design, the **DPIIT Startup Recognition Period** has been extended from **10 to 15 years for semiconductor and deep tech companies**. This aligns policy with the reality of "Hardware-is-Hard" cycles.



Monetising Indian IP

TISM 2.0 prioritises **full-stack Indian IP, incentivising startups to own core architectures—not just design for global clients**. Budget 2026 introduced a ₹10,000 Crore SME Growth Fund to fuel high-potential SMEs with equity and risk capital, positioning them as global leaders.



AI-Silicon Convergence

The **Compute Credit Scheme** now gives **deep tech founders access to sovereign AI compute infrastructure**, enabling startups to co-optimize chip designs with India-specific AI workloads—building a powerful hardware-software advantage.

Semiconductor Workforce



Curriculum Integration

The ₹1,000 Crore ISM 2.0 allocation for FY27 targets **industry-driven research and training hubs**. Through the Chips to Startup (C2S) and Design Linked Incentive (DLI) programs, **over 250 academic institutions and 65 startups (315+ organizations)** are now collaborating with foundries to accelerate hands-on chip design and tape-outs



The "Shakti" Initiative

This ₹10,000 Cr ecosystem play focuses on **high-end PhD research and specialised VLSI engineering**. The goal is to **produce 85,000 industry-ready engineers** annually by 2027 to staff the four major plants (Tata, Micron, CG Power, Kaynes) beginning production this year.



Global Mobility & Standards:

By aligning training centers with global standards, **India is positioning its workforce not just for domestic fabs but as the primary talent exporter for the global "China+1" semiconductor strategy**.

Indian Government's IP Push & The Opportunity For India Startups

Strategic Pillar	The Old Paradigm (Pre-ISM 2.0)	The New Reality (Post-ISM 2.0 & Budget 2026)
 Business Model	Design Services - Indian engineers executed sub-blocks for global IDMs (Intel, Qualcomm). - Revenue was linear (fee-for-service). Result: Zero ownership of the final Silicon IP.	Product Ownership - Focus on indigenous Fabless Startups creating original IP. - Revenue is non-linear (licensing fees & unit sales). Result: Creation of an asset class (Patents/IP).
 Incentive Structure	Generic IT Benefits - Incentives were limited to standard software export schemes (SEZ/STPI). - No distinction between writing code and designing complex chip architecture.	Targeted DLI Scheme Design Linked Incentive (DLI) offers up to 50% reimbursement on design expenditure. - Deployment-linked payouts (4-6% of net sales) to reward commercial success.
 Capital & Risk Profile	The Hardware Valley Of Death - VCs avoided chip startups due to high risk and long gestation period. - Founders often forced to flip to US/Singapore for funding.	De-Risked Innovation Shakti Initiative (₹10,000 Cr) provides "patient capital" specifically for hardware. - Government subsidies "Tape-outs," effectively removing the biggest barrier to entry.
 Infrastructure Access	High-Barrier To Entry - Access to industry-standard EDA tools (Cadence, Synopsys) was prohibitively expensive. - Prototyping had to be done at foreign foundries at full market rates.	Democratised Access Chips to Startup (C2S) program provides subsidised access to high-end EDA tools. - Preferential access to the Semi-Conductor Laboratory (SCL) for low-cost prototyping runs.
 Strategic Focus Area	Global Legacy Nodes - Work was often limited to maintaining legacy global platforms. - Little connection to India's specific domestic needs.	Future-Ready Niches - Direct support for RISC-V (Open Source) to build sovereign processors. - Focus on high-growth domestic verticals: 5G/6G Telecom, EV Power Modules, and Edge AI.
 Market Access	Global Dependency - Startups had to compete globally from Day 1 with no local customer base. - Indian defense/infra used imported chips due to lack of local alternatives.	Guaranteed Demand Preferential Market Access (PMA) mandates local sourcing for government procurement (Defence, Railways, 5G). "Trusted Source" norms favor Indian IP for critical infrastructure projects.

Sectors Driving Semiconductor Growth In India

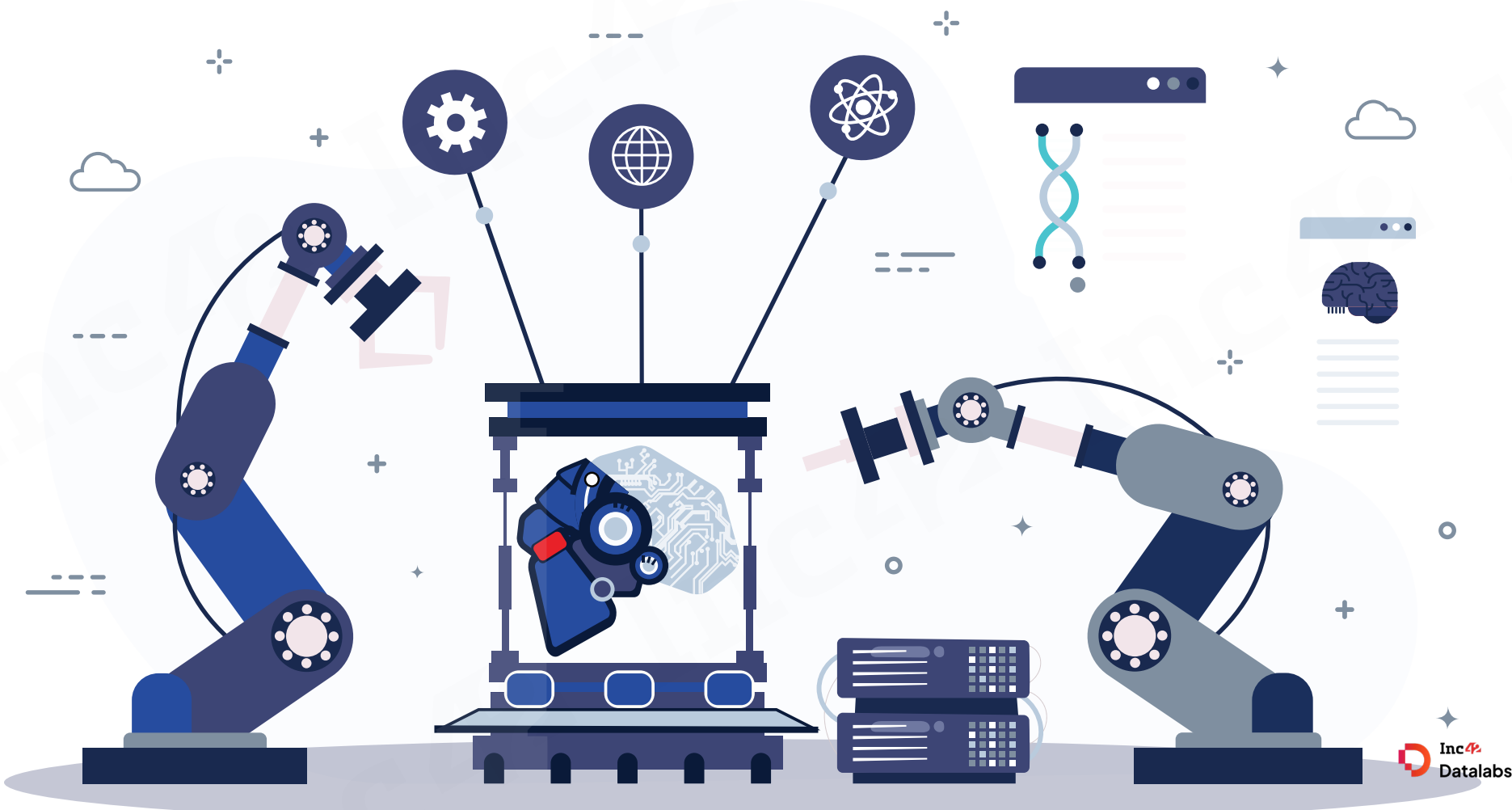
India’s semiconductor demand is fueled by growth in electronics, mobility, connectivity, and digital infrastructure. For startups, the opportunity isn’t the entire value chain, but the specific chips, components, and subsystems these sectors need.

The table below links key demand drivers to the semiconductor capabilities they rely on and highlights practical entry points for new companies.

Sector	Market Size (2026)	Market Size (2031)	Semiconductor Need	Demand Catalysts	Startup Entry Points
 Consumer Electronics	\$27 Bn	\$59 Bn	Application processors, power management ICs, sensors, connectivity chips	140 Mn+ smartphones consumed annually; Apple’s China+1 (20% of global iPhones assembled in India); wearables/smart-home/tablet expansion	Analogue/mixed-signal design; sensor ICs; wireless modules; testing & packaging services
 Telecom & 5G Infrastructure	\$21 Bn	\$36 Bn	RF front-end modules, baseband processors, networking ASICs	779-district 5G coverage; 460K+ base stations commissioned; BharatNet fibre backhaul reaching 4 Mn km; private 5G in manufacturing & port corridors	RF design; signal-processing chips; specialised IP blocks; telecom-grade testing
 Automotive & EV	\$5 Bn	\$20 Bn	Power semiconductors (SiC/GaN), battery management systems, microcontrollers, sensors	Charging infra buildout (PM-KUSUM + state EV policies); Tata-PSMC Dholera 28nm fab targeting auto power-management sweet spot; L2+ autonomous-driving adoption accelerating	Power electronics design; BMS ICs; automotive-grade testing; compound semiconductor devices
 AI & Data Centres	\$4.3 Bn	\$23 Bn	Accelerators, memory packaging, networking silicon, high-speed interconnects	Hyperscalers expansion (Reliance Jio Cloud, Yotta, Adani edge clusters); Budget 2026 cloud tax holiday to 2047; push to expand India data centre capacity by 2030	Edge AI chips; chiplet integration; advanced packaging; cooling & power subsystems

Source: Inc42 Analysis, IESA, McKinsey

	Industrial IoT & Smart Infrastructure	\$2.5 Bn	\$9.3 Bn	Low-power controllers, sensor networks, connectivity modules	Rare-earth corridor monitoring & automation needs; Industry 4.0 across manufacturing mega-corridors; 100+ Smart Cities Mission sensor deployments	MEMS sensors; embedded processors; industrial communication chips
	Defence & Aerospace	\$1.2 Bn	\$4.6 Bn	Secure processors, radiation-hardened chips, communication systems	iDEX/C2S defence-deeptech pipeline (AGNIT, others); ₹6.81 Lakh Cr defence budget, arms procurement & modernisation; Chandrayaan-3 proved indigenous nav-chip capability	Trusted electronics; specialised ASICs; ruggedised components; defence-grade testing
	Healthcare & Wearables	\$0.6 Bn	\$3.1 Bn	Ultra-low-power chips, biosensors, signal-processing ICs	AI diagnostics scaling in Ayushman Bharat hospitals; edge AI demand for drug discovery/robotics; growing wearables market driven by health-conscious consumers	Medical-grade sensors; Analogue front-end chips; low-power SoCs



Landscape Of Indian Semiconductor Startup Ecosystem



Source: Inc42

Note: The figures represent capital raised between 2014 and 2025 | We have not included Tessolve (Hero Electronix group) \$150 Mn funding round in the calculations | The number of active investors is estimated, based on disclosed rounds and publicly available information | The names featured in Corporate & CVC also includes organisations who have expressed interest towards backing of supporting India's semiconductor startups. | This is not an exhaustive list.

Notable Indian Semiconductor Startups

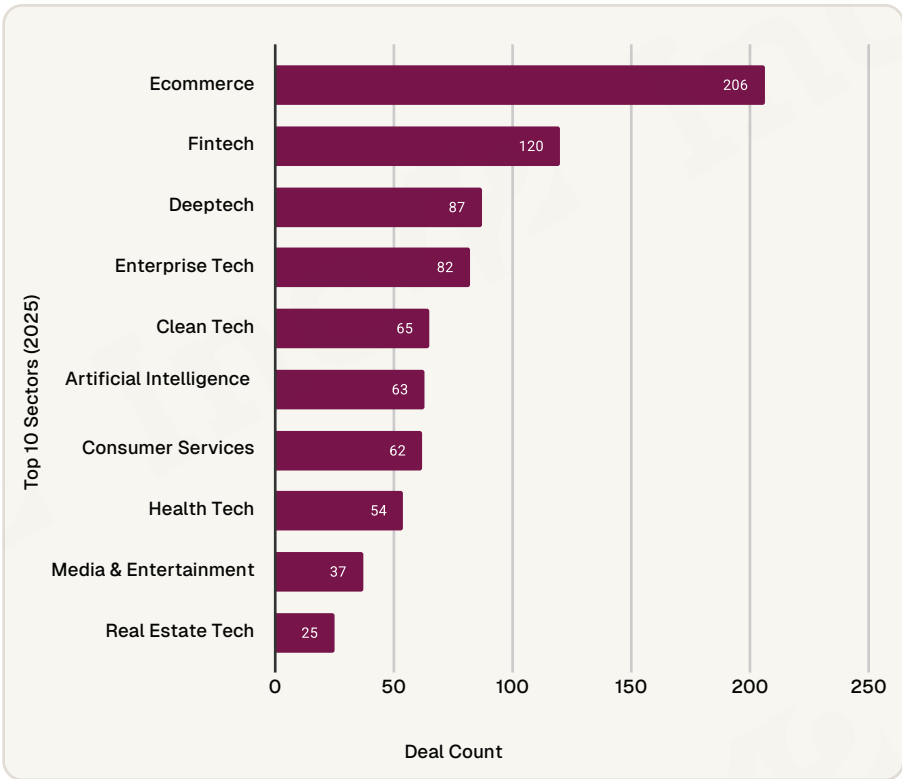
Key Parameters					Offerings & Value Proposition	
 AGNIT  Aura Semiconductor  FERMIONIC  iVP SEMI  MINDGROVE	Total Funding	Stage	Investors	Offerings	Model	Analyst Take
	~\$4.9 Mn	Seed	3one4 Capital, Zephyr Peacock	Gallium Nitride (GaN) semiconductors for RF and Power electronics.	IDM (Integrated Device Manufacturer)	One of the few true hardware/materials startups. Their GaN capabilities are strategically vital for EV power trains and 5G infrastructure, aligning perfectly with India's push for reducing import dependence in power electronics.
	~\$6 Mn	Growth	Celesta Capital (WRVI), Mayfield	High-performance Analogue & Mixed-Signal ICs (Timing, Power, RF) for 5G and IoT.	Product Focused	Unlike early-stage peers, Aura is a mature player with a high barrier to entry (Analogue/Mixed-Signal). They have successfully validated the 'Designed in India' thesis with global clientele.
	~\$6 Mn	Seed	Ashish Kacholia, Qualcomm (Grant)	SerDes (Serializer /Deserializer) IP and Optical Engine Drivers for high-speed data transmission.	IP Provider	A classic "pick-and-shovel" play. High-quality SerDes IP is a prerequisite for high-performance computing. Their niche expertise makes them an attractive acquisition target for global semiconductor majors seeking to bolster their IP blocks.
	~\$5 Mn	Seed	Undisclosed	Power discretes, MOSFETs, and Modules for Renewable Energy and EVs.	Fabless Product	Led by industry insiders Raja Manickam (ex-Tessolve), iVP is executing an import-substitution playbook. They are targeting immediate, high-volume demand in the solar and EV sectors rather than chasing experimental tech, ensuring faster path-to-revenue.
	~\$8 Mn	Series A	Peak XV Partners, Rocketship.vc, Speciale Invest	RISC-V based Systems-on-Chip (SoCs) for IoT, Vision, and Edge applications.	Fabless Product	Leveraging the open-source RISC-V architecture to disrupt the mid-market IoT sector. Their strategy avoids direct competition with high-end incumbents (Intel/Nvidia) by targeting cost-sensitive, high-volume industrial and surveillance markets.

Source: Inc42
Note: This is not an exhaustive list or a ranking. It is a curated sample of select startups highlighted for representation. The funding data mentioned here is as of February 2026.

Key Parameters					Offerings & Value Proposition	
	Total Funding	Stage	Investors	Offerings	Model	Analyst Take
	~\$4.3 Mn	Growth	IAN Alpha Fund, Speciale Invest, IvyCap Ventures	REDEFINE™ (Runtime Reconfigurable Many-core Processor) for HPC and Data Centres.	IP / Fabless	An IISc spin-off offering a breakthrough architecture: ASIC-level performance with FPGA-like flexibility. As data centres demand heterogeneous compute for AI, their reconfigurable cores offer a unique efficiency advantage.
	~\$14.6 Mn	Growth	Zoho Corp, Unicorn India Ventures	Edge AI SoCs (Specter/Netra series), Chiplet architectures for vision and autonomous systems.	Fabless / IP	Strategic backing by Zoho signals a move towards hardware-software sovereignty. Their chiplet-based approach allows for scalable, high-performance edge computing, addressing the bottleneck in local AI processing.
	~\$65 Mn	Growth	Avataar Ventures, National Quantum Mission (DST)	Full-stack Quantum Compute (Superconducting qubits) & AI compilation software.	Full Stack (Hardware + Software)	The most ambitious deeptech play on the list. By integrating quantum hardware with AI software, they are positioning themselves as a foundational pillar for India's quantum sovereignty, validated by significant government backing.
	Acquired (~\$28 Mn prior)		Tejas Networks (Tata Group), Intel Capital, GM Venture	Software Defined Radio (SDR) chipsets, Satellite ground terminals, 5G Broadcast solutions.	Product & IP	A critical asset in the Tata Group's vertical integration strategy for telecom. Their SDR technology is pivotal for indigenous 5G/6G infrastructure and defence communications.
	~\$3 Mn	Seed	Piper Serica, LetsVenture	Ultra-low power SoCs for Internet of Medical Things (IoMT) and Wearables.	Fabless Product	Distinctive differentiation through analogue-domain AI processing, which drastically reduces power consumption. This positions them uniquely in the 'implantable' and 'wearable' medical device market where battery life is the primary constraint.

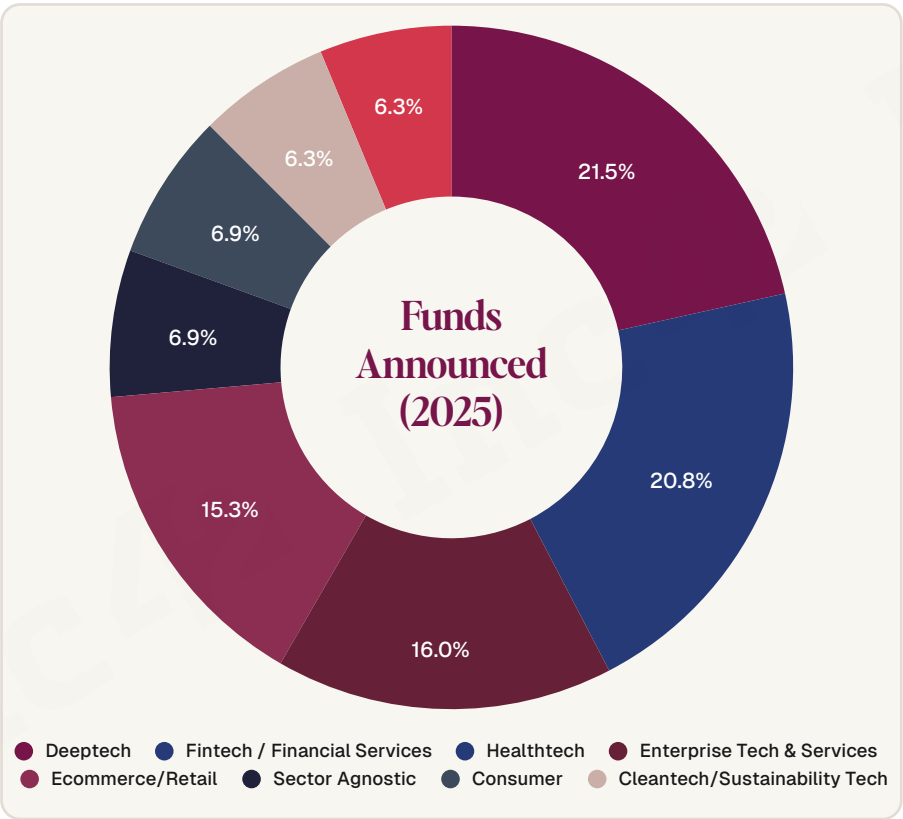
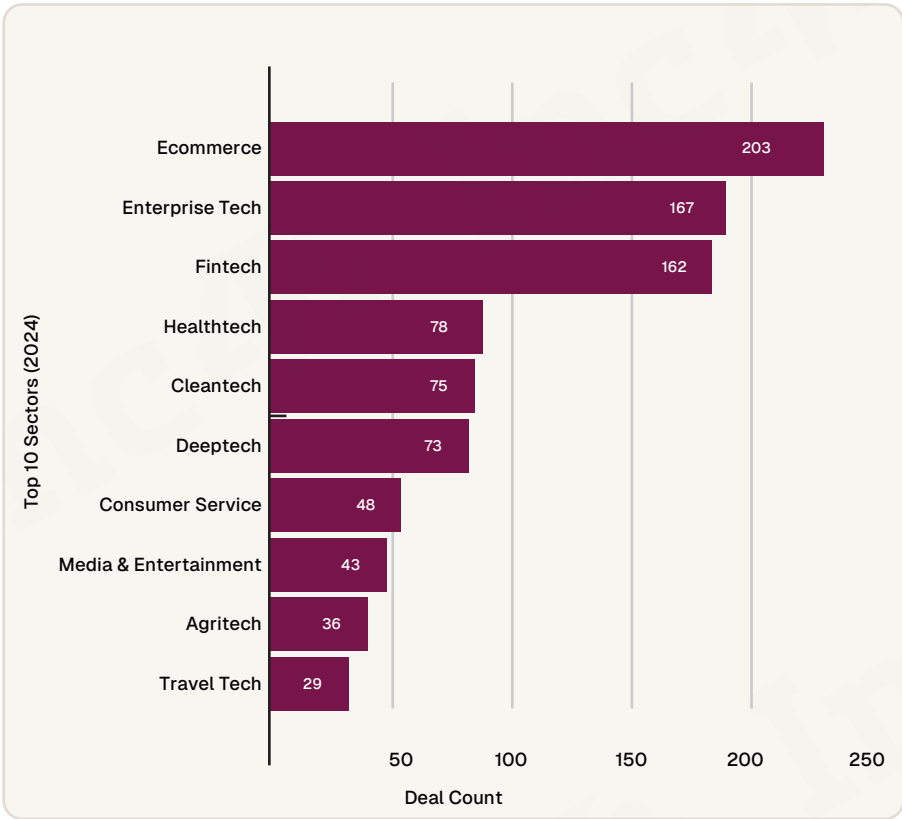
Source: Inc42
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Deeptech Momentum In India Strengthens, Laying Groundwork For Chip Innovation



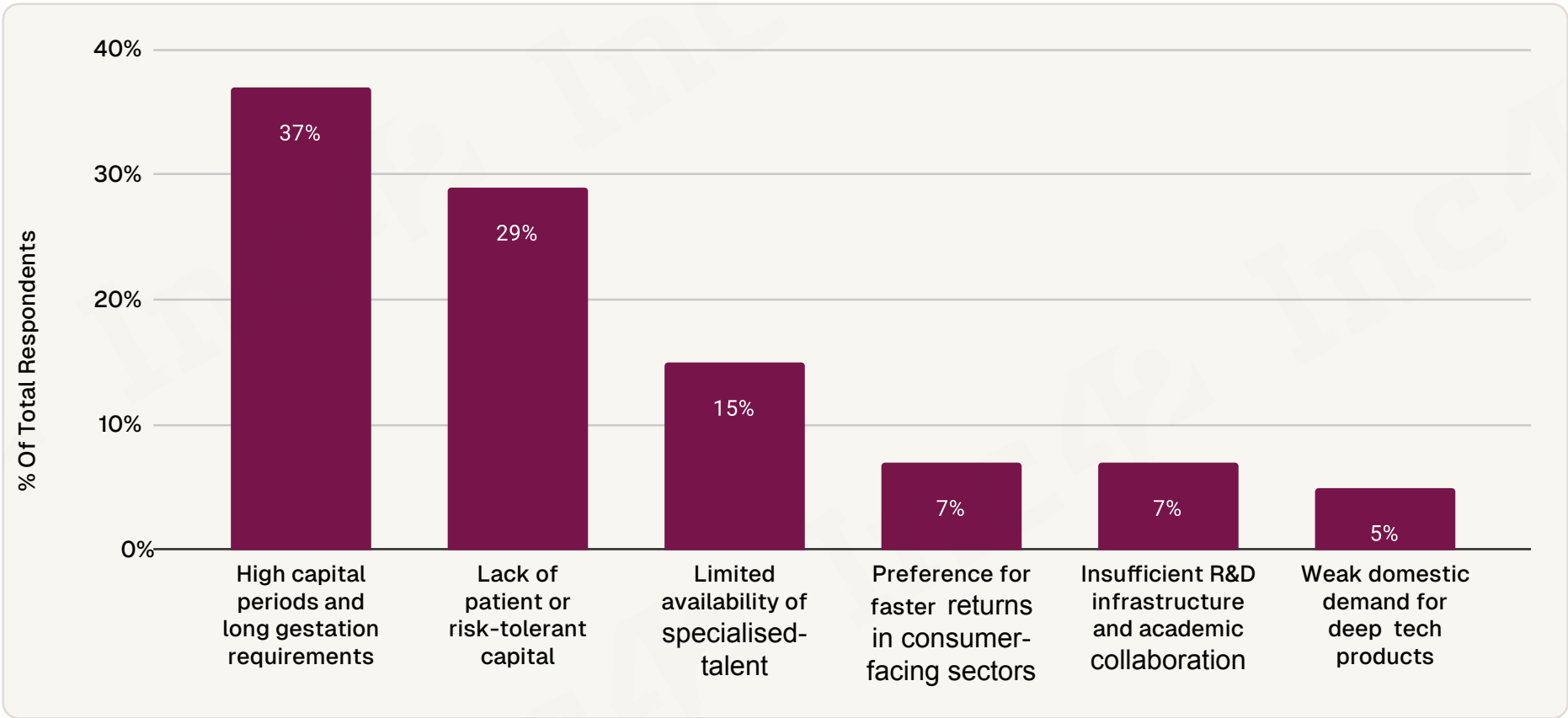
For the first time, deeptech has emerged as the third-highest funded sector by deal volume, reflecting robust momentum in early stage investments. Although it ranked seventh by total funding value, the high number of deals underscores widespread activity in seed and early-growth stages.

This trend is further reinforced by fund formation: 31 out of 90 funds announced in 2025 explicitly include deeptech in their investment mandates. This signals not only the sector’s rapid on-ground expansion but also its growing institutionalisation in capital allocation, laying the foundation for a sustained, multi-year growth phase.



Source: Inc42 Analysis
Note: Data as of 20 December, 2025 | Based on analysis of funds announced / closed / partially closed in 2025

Indian Investors Cite CapEx And Shortage Of Patient Capital As Key Barriers To Deeptech Innovation



The Inc42 survey of 80+ institutional investors in 2025 exposes a critical vulnerability in India's ambitions to build a world-class deeptech ecosystem. While the country has demonstrated remarkable success in consumer internet and SaaS startups, the data reveals a stark reality: India's investment infrastructure is fundamentally misaligned with the requirements of capital-intensive, long-gestation deeptech ventures. With 66% of investors pointing to capital constraints, either the sheer quantum required or the lack of patient, risk-tolerant funding, India faces a structural challenge that cannot be solved by incremental fixes.

The Capital Paradox: Nearly two-thirds (66%) of investors identify capital-related challenges as the primary bottleneck, combining high capital requirements (37%) with lack of patient capital (29%). This reveals a fundamental mismatch between deeptech's needs and India's investment ecosystem, which has historically favored asset-light, quick-return models.

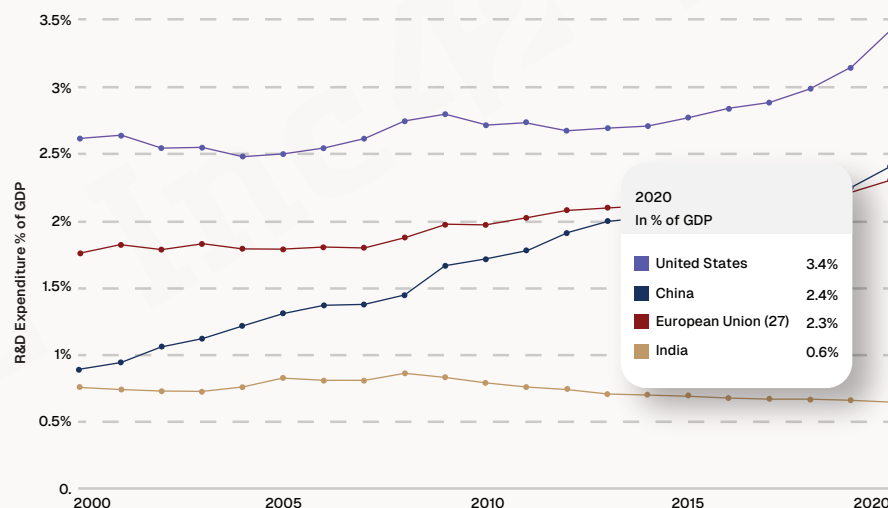
Talent Gap Remains Critical: While 15% cite specialised talent shortage, this understates the challenge. Deeptech requires highly specialised researchers and engineers with advanced degrees, a talent pool that remains limited despite India's large STEM graduate base.

The Consumer Tech Bias: 7% explicitly cite preference for consumer-facing sectors, but this cultural bias likely influences the capital shortage issue as well. Indian VC success stories have predominantly come from consumer internet, creating path dependency in investor mindset.

Source: Inc42 Survey
Note: This analysis is based on a survey of more than 80 institutional investors, including partners and principals

India Needs To Spend At Least \$100 Bn+ Annually On R&D By 2030

India's R&D Intensity Lags Far Behind Global Innovation Leaders



India's Semiconductor Competitiveness Requires A Two-Part Shift By 2030

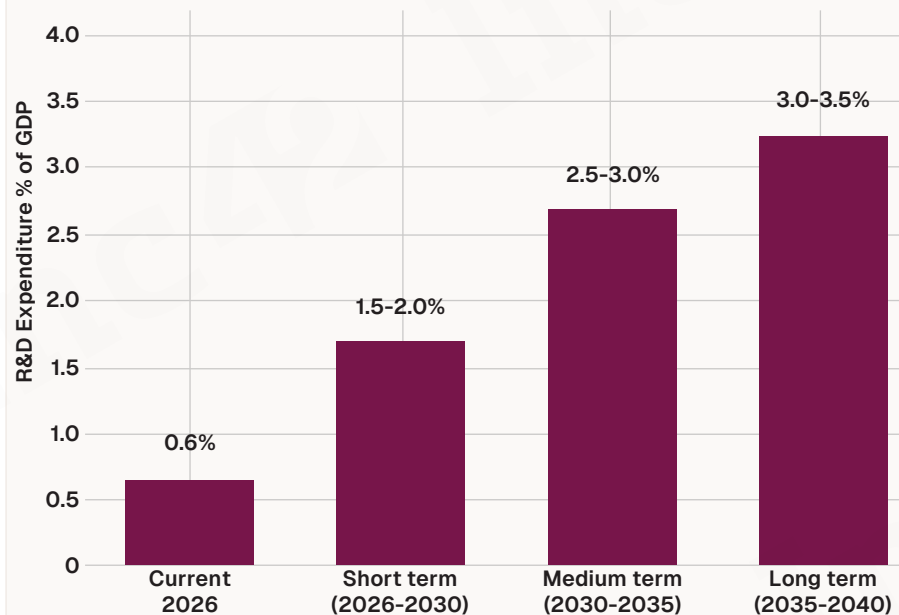
R&D intensity rising toward ~1.5% of GDP

Private sector share increasing from ~41% to 60%+

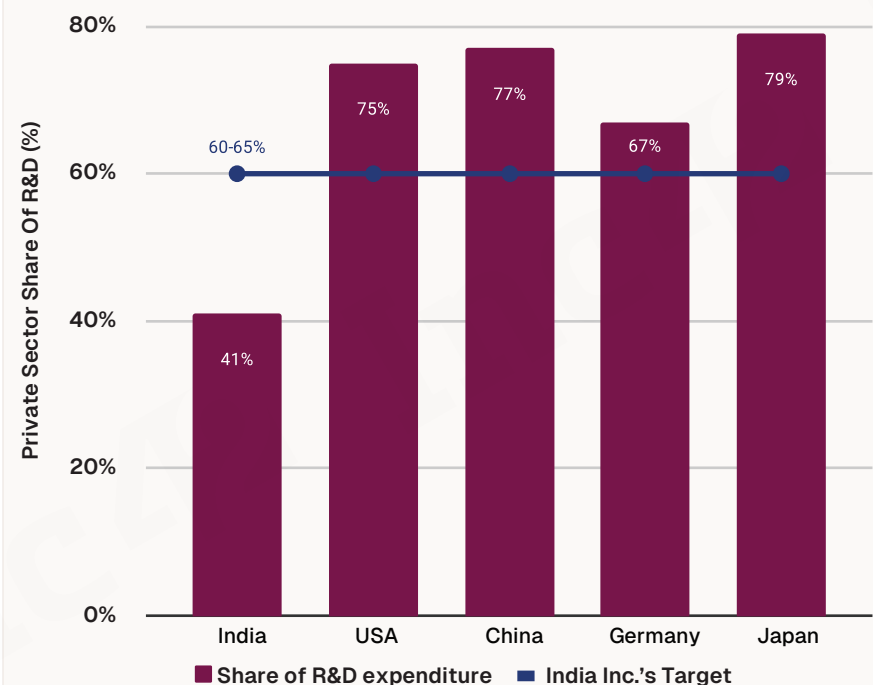
Transition from state-driven research to enterprise-led innovation

Focus on compounding IP creation rather than one-time spending

India Must Lift R&D Intensity From ~0.6% To 1.5% By 2030



India's Private Sector Funds 41% Of R&D



Source: Inc42 Analysis, World Bank, GOI

Note: WIPO reports India's 2024 R&D spending at \$74 Bn on a PPP basis. The \$100 Bn+ projection referenced here is calculated in nominal dollar terms.

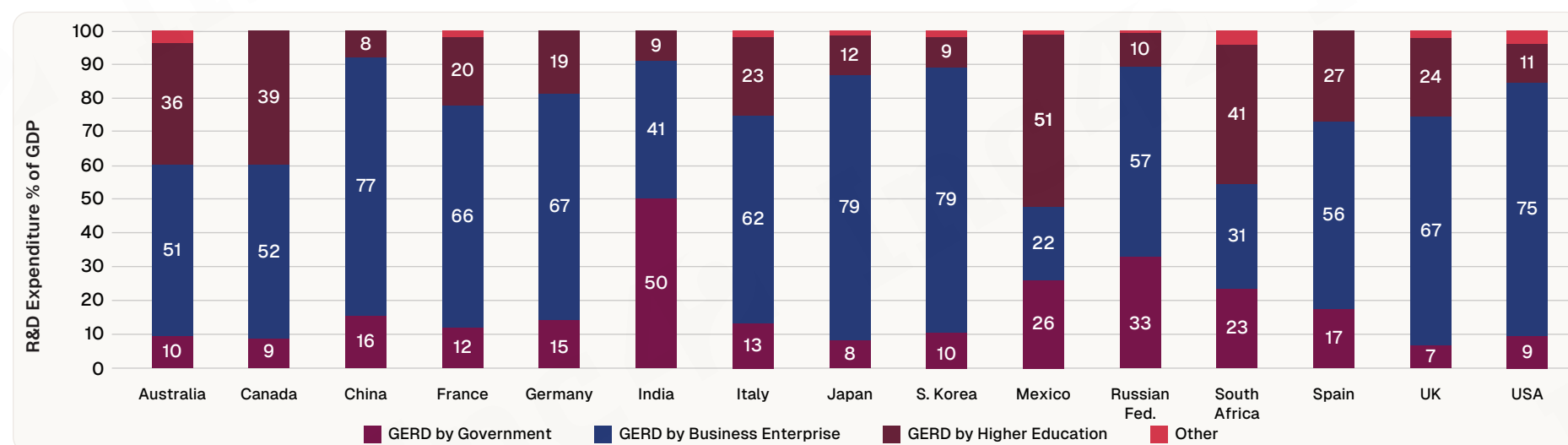
Corporate R&D Participation Is India's Key Innovation Bottleneck

India's innovation system remains disproportionately dependent on public funding, unlike global technology leaders where corporate investment drives research and commercialisation.

In India, business enterprises contribute roughly 41% of total R&D spending, compared with 65–79% in advanced economies such as the United States, Japan, and Germany. This limits the ability to translate research into scalable products and proprietary technologies.

Corporate-led R&D is particularly critical for deeptech sectors like semiconductors, artificial intelligence, and advanced manufacturing, where development cycles are long, capital intensity is high, and commercial deployment requires sustained private investment.

Without stronger enterprise participation, increases in public spending alone will not produce globally competitive innovation outcomes.



To reach a 60%+ **corporate share of R&D spending by 2030**, private capital must move beyond incremental research toward high-impact technological frontiers.

Priority areas include:

- 🌟 **Semiconductor Manufacturing & Design:** Developing indigenous fabrication, packaging, and chip architecture capabilities
- 🌟 **Deeptech & AI:** Advancing foundational technologies such as advanced computing, robotics, and next-generation software systems
- 🌟 **Strategic Industrial Innovation:** Strengthening critical sectors that underpin economic resilience and national competitiveness

Government initiatives such as the **Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF)** and the **Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund** aim to **de-risk private participation**. However, long-term success depends on sustained increases in corporate R&D allocations.

India's transition to a global innovation economy will be driven primarily by enterprise investment rather than public expenditure alone.

Source: Inc42 Analysis, Ministry Of Science & Technology (GOI)
Note: GERD stands for Gross Expenditure on Research and Development

India's Semiconductor Readiness: Strengths, Weaknesses & Threats

Strengths

Massive Design Talent Reservoir: India currently provides ~20% of the world's semiconductor design workforce, offering an unparalleled "talent-to-capex" ratio for R&D.

Long-Term Policy Continuity: The transition from ISM 1.0 to ISM 2.0 provides 10-year visibility, which is critical for the 3–5 year gestation periods of fabs.

Growing Domestic Market: The explosion of Indian EVs, 5G infrastructure, and digital consumer electronics creates a built-in safety net for "trailing edge" node production.

Fiscal Support Depth: The government offers up to 50% fiscal support for capital expenditure on fabs and packaging units, making it one of the world's most aggressive subsidy regimes.

Weaknesses

Infrastructure Reliability Gap: Industrial power and water reliability (SAIFI/outage metrics) remain lower than mature hubs like Malaysia, necessitating high-cost onsite redundancy.

Upstream Supply Chain Voids: India remains 90%+ dependent on imported high-purity chemicals, gases, and specialised equipment.

Low R&D Intensity: India's R&D spend as a percentage of GDP remains stagnant at ~0.6%, significantly trailing global peers and limiting cutting-edge domestic innovation.

Nascent Commercial Ecosystem: While India excels in services (GCCs), it lacks a mature ecosystem of domestic Tier I & II suppliers for fab consumables.

Opportunities

"China+1" Strategic Arbitrage: Global OEMs are actively diversifying supply chains; India is positioned as the primary democratic alternative for high-tech manufacturing.

Leadership In Green Electronics: The global shift to EVs and renewable energy grids creates a massive opening for India to lead in Compound Semiconductors (GaN/SiC).

Rise Of Open Architecture (RISC-V): India's push for the indigenous DHRUV64 microprocessor enables a move toward open-source silicon that bypasses traditional Western IP royalties.

AI Infrastructure Boom: The projected 26% growth in AI chip revenue for 2026 creates immediate demand for the advanced memory packaging (HBM) targeted by players like Micron.

Threats

Global Subsidy Arms Race: Massive outlays from the US, EU, and Japan (multi-billion dollar CHIPS Acts) threaten to siphon away high-end foundry investment.

Talent "Brain Drain": Specialised process engineers (manufacturing talent) are in high demand globally; India risks losing its best minds to mature ecosystems in Taiwan or Singapore.

Cyclical Memory Volatility: With 25% of the market tied to memory, a global price correction (like the 50% spikes projected for mid-2026) could impact the profitability of Indian OSAT units.

Rapid Technological Obsolescence: The fast shift from 7 nm to 2 nm nodes (high demand growth) risks making India's early focus on legacy nodes (28 nm+) less relevant for high-performance computing.

India's Semiconductor Startup Opportunities



Design & Compute

- Edge AI chips & domain-specific accelerators for automotive, surveillance, robotics and industrial use
- Analogue and mixed-signal design for power electronics, telecom and sensor interfaces
- Custom IP cores and RISC-V architectures as alternatives to licensed ARM ecosystems
- EDA and verification tools addressing high licensing costs and workflow bottlenecks
- Cloud-based simulation and semiconductor SaaS platforms

Low capital intensity, talent-driven, exportable from Day 1



Power, EV & Industrial Semiconductors

- Wide-bandgap power devices (SiC, GaN) for EVs, grid infrastructure and renewables
- Battery management ICs and motor control chips
- Industrial automation and telecom power components

Domestic demand surge + supply chain security priorities



Defence, Aerospace & Strategic Electronics

- Radiation-hardened chips and secure processors
- Communication and surveillance electronics
- Indigenous components for missiles, drones and space systems

Long contracts, high entry barriers, policy support



Materials, Chemicals & Consumables

- High-purity chemicals, photoresists and specialty gases
- CMP slurries, wafers, substrates and process materials
- Recycling and purification solutions for fab inputs

>90% import dependence creates structural demand



Equipment, Subsystems & Fab Services

- Refurbishment and maintenance of imported tools
- Vacuum, RF and gas delivery subsystems
- Metrology, inspection and yield analytics services

Recurring demand with lower capex than building new tools



Packaging, Testing & Chiplets

- OSAT services and advanced packaging solutions
- Chiplet integration platforms and thermal solutions
- Testing infrastructure for automotive and AI chips

Critical bottleneck with limited domestic capacity



MEMS & Sensor Ecosystem

- Automotive and industrial sensors
- Wearable and medical MEMS devices
- Sensor packaging and ASIC integration

Rapid growth from EV, IoT and smart infrastructure demand



Talent, Infrastructure & Enablement Platforms

- VLSI training and certification ecosystems
- Cleanroom-as-a-service for startups and universities
- AI-driven yield optimisation and digital fab tools

Addresses India's talent shortage and infrastructure gaps

India’s Semiconductor Startup Opportunity Heatmap

India’s first wave of semiconductor unicorns is far more likely to emerge from design, packaging, tools and ecosystem services than from fabs. These segments combine export potential with manageable capital requirements and faster commercial validation.

Layer / Theme	Time to Revenue	Capital Intensity	Startup Feasibility	Execution Notes
Chip Design & IP (Analogue, RISC-V, domain chips)	Fast	Low	High	Talent-driven, exportable, minimal infrastructure
EDA, Verification & Simulation Tools	Moderate	Low	High	Software-first, global customers possible
Packaging, Testing & OSAT Services	Moderate	Medium	High	Critical bottleneck, strong demand
Equipment Refurbishment & Fab Services	Moderate	Medium	High	Recurring revenue, lower capex than new tools
Power & EV Semiconductors (SiC/GaN)	Moderate	High	Medium	Large demand but manufacturing complexity
Materials, Chemicals & Specialty Gases	Moderate	High	Medium	Import substitution play with scale requirements
MEMS & Sensors	Moderate	High	Medium	Strong growth but qualification cycles
Fab Subsystems & Components	Slow	High	Medium	Needs industrial capability build-up
Advanced Nodes & Frontier Technologies	Very Slow	Very High	Low	Capital-heavy, global competition

Most venture-backable near-term opportunities

Viable but infrastructure-dependent

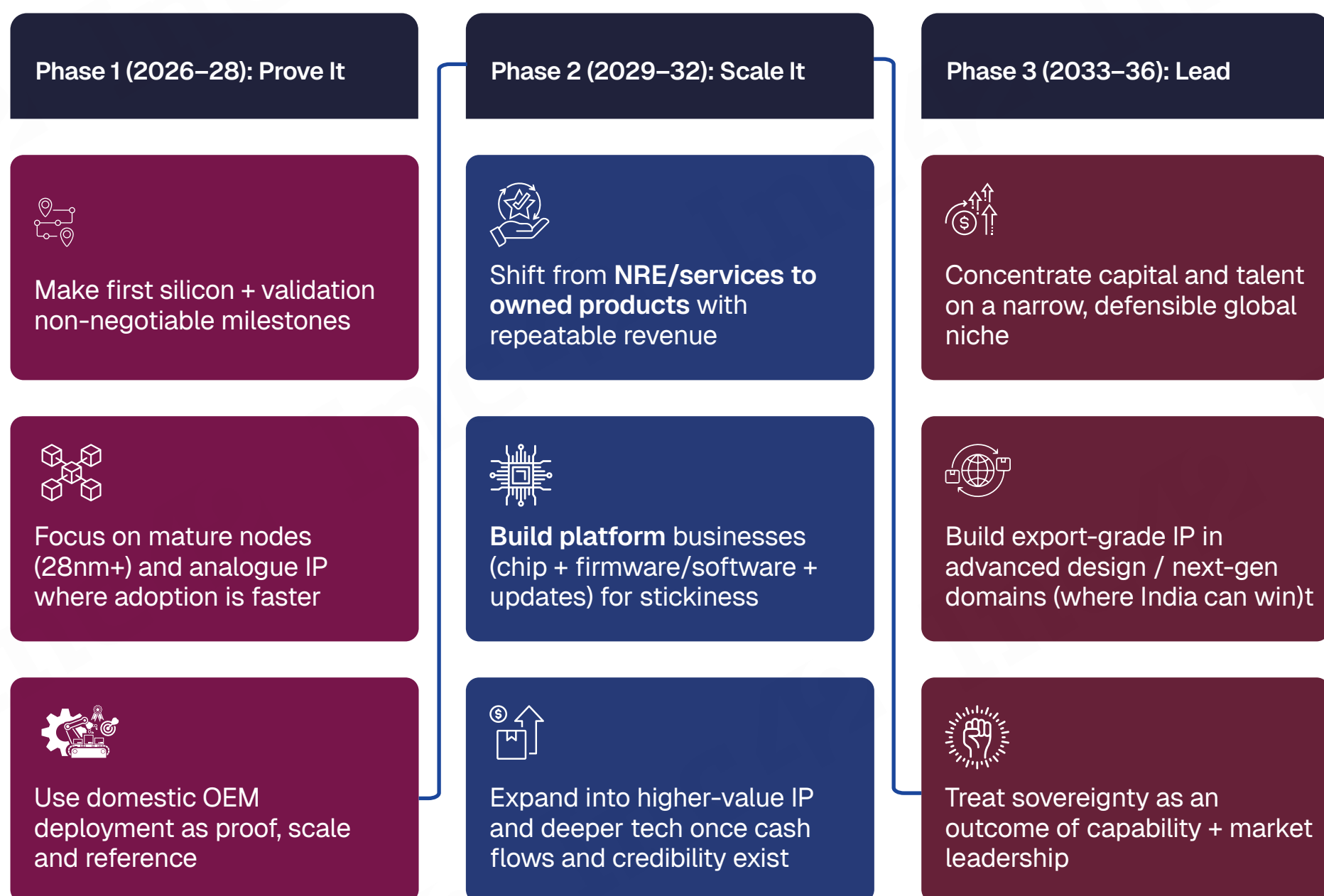
Strategic national bets, not typical startup plays

Ten Years Roadmap For Indian Semiconductor Startups

India's semiconductor opportunity will be decided less by the size of incentives and more by execution velocity — how quickly startups move from design → **validation** → **repeatable revenue**.

The credible path is **sequenced**: win early on mature nodes and real demand, convert capability into products, then compound into advanced design and exportable IP.

The Sequenced Path Across Three Phases



Phase	Objective	Focus Areas	Startup Action Pathways
Building Manufacturing Credibility (2026–2028)	Lower the perceived risk of building and operating semiconductor facilities in India by demonstrating consistent production, dependable logistics, and predictable policy support.	✦ ATMP/OSAT Support: Filling the vacuum for domestic testing equipment, probe cards, and ADR software as fabs come online. ✦ Analogue & Mixed-Signal IP: High-barrier, lower-capital chips (PMICs, Sensors) for industrial automation and telecom. ✦ Legacy Node Utilisation (28nm+): Robust, automotive-grade MCUs on mature nodes where yield is high and demand is massive.	✦ Execute "First Silicon": Focus relentlessly on getting the first chip tape-out done and validated. ✦ Target High-Volume Domestic Demand: Address immediate, large-scale needs in sectors like Smart Metering and Electric 2-Wheelers to generate early revenue and prove traction. ✦ Build Credibility: Move from pure design services to owning a validated product IP.
Moving Up The Value Chain (2029–2032)	Shift from dependence on imported technology to domestic innovation, including chip design, specialised materials, and advanced components tailored to Indian and global markets.	✦ Compound Semiconductors (GaN/SiC): Designing indigenous wide-bandgap wafers for the maturing EV and consumer electronics market. ✦ RISC-V Commercialisation: Moving beyond cores to customised RISC-V SoCs for specific verticals (e.g., drone controllers, UPI soundboxes). ✦ Servitisation of Chips: Bundling chips with proprietary software stacks (e.g., AI edge processors with subscription updates) for recurring revenue.	✦ Shift Revenue Mix: Successfully transition from NRE (service) revenue to product-based revenue streams. ✦ Create Defensive IP: Build a strong patent portfolio in US/EU jurisdictions. ✦ Align with National Priorities: Target strategic sectors like commercial EVs (buses/trucks) and defence drones where import substitution is a government mandate.
Global Technology Leadership (2033–2036)	Develop defensible technological strengths that make India indispensable in selected semiconductor segments, supported by strong intellectual property and international partnerships.	✦ <5nm Design Leadership: Targeting high-performance computing (HPC) for data centers using advanced finFET/GAA designs. ✦ Photonics & Quantum: Entering the "winner-take-most" frontier of Silicon Photonics for speed and Quantum error-correction chips. ✦ Net Exporter of IP: Licensing homemade IP out to global foundries and design houses.	✦ Achieve Niche Global Leadership: Dominate a specific high-performance niche globally (e.g., "world's most efficient AI inference chip"). ✦ Flip the Business Model: Become a net exporter of technology, reversing the traditional flow of IP licensing. ✦ Define Future Standards: Participate in and influence global standards bodies for 6G and exascale computing.

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Methodology

Since 2015, Inc42 has tracked Indian startups transforming industries and shaping the country's digital economy.

Key Definitions

- ✦ **Semiconductor:** A base material (typically silicon) with electrical conductivity that can be precisely controlled, acting as a switch or amplifier for electrical currents.
- ✦ **Node:** A commercial generation of semiconductor manufacturing technology. Historically, it referred to the physical dimension of the transistors on a chip (measured in nanometers).
- ✦ **Wafer:** A wafer is an ultra-pure semiconductor slice (typically silicon) that serves as the foundation for building microcircuits, with each wafer capable of holding hundreds or thousands of chips.
- ✦ **Fab / Foundry (Fabrication Plant):** A highly specialized, multi-billion-dollar manufacturing facility where integrated circuits (chips) are chemically and optically etched onto bare silicon wafers.
- ✦ **OSAT (Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test) / ATMP:** Back-end: cutting wafers into chips, packaging, testing, and shipping to manufacturers.
- ✦ **EDA (Electronic Design Automation):** Specialized software for designing, simulating, and verifying integrated circuit layouts pre-manufacturing
- ✦ **GERD:** Gross Expenditure on Research and Development

Funding Stages

- **Seed stage:** Angel / Seed rounds
- **Growth stage:** Series A / Series B
- **Late stage:** Series C and above
- ✦ **Unicorn:** Any digital/tech company valued at \$1 Bn or above, or that has touched this valuation at least once.
- ✦ **Market Size Convention:** Unless specified otherwise, market size refers to the Total Addressable Market (TAM), estimated using a blend of top-down and bottom-up methods.

Data Notes: Our database is regularly enriched. As a result, minor variations in funding-related data versus previously released Inc42 reports may occur.

Methodology

Market Size Calculations

This analysis measures India's semiconductor consumption market, defined as the total value of semiconductor components consumed within India, including both imported semiconductors and domestically manufactured chips. This metric differs from production-based estimates, which only account for chips manufactured on Indian soil. The consumption approach provides a more comprehensive view of India's semiconductor market opportunity, as it captures the full ecosystem demand that could be addressed through a combination of domestic manufacturing scale-up and continued strategic imports.

- ✦ Bottom-up segment analysis across seven end-use categories (mobile, automotive, IT, telecom, industrial, defense, healthcare), projecting unit volumes, semiconductor content per device, and local sourcing ratios
- ✦ Top-down growth modelling starting from IESA's \$52 Bn FY2024-25 baseline, with policy-adjusted projections incorporating Union Budget 2026 incentives and approved India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) projects worth \$19 Bn in committed investments
- ✦ Data triangulation from authoritative sources: IESA industry surveys, WSTS global forecasts, government ISM project tracking, and electronics production actuals under PLI schemes
- ✦ Global market benchmarking using consensus forecasts (\$987 Bn in 2026, \$1,805 Bn in 2031) that reflect AI infrastructure demand, automotive electrification, and memory market cycles

Market Size Calculations

- ✦ Policy Catalyst via ISM 2.0: The recent launch of the India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 marks a strategic pivot from basic capacity creation to full-stack technological depth. Supported by augmented budget outlays (including the expanded ₹40,000 Cr ECMS), this framework accelerates the localised development of Indian core IP, specialised fab equipment, and critical raw material corridors.
- ✦ Electronics Manufacturing Scale-Up: Production is aggressively targeting the official \$500 Bn mandate by 2030-31 under PLI and ECMS frameworks. With semiconductors consistently commanding a 38-42% share of the electronics Bill of Materials (BOM), this scale-up mathematically guarantees massive localised chip demand.
- ✦ Accelerated Import Substitution: Strategic reduction of historical import dependency from 90-95% down to 65-70% by 2031. This shift is locked in as domestic fabs and OSAT facilities, led by Micron, Tata Electronics, and CG Power, transition to commercial production in the 2026-2027 window.

Projections are strictly grounded in consistent 38-42% semiconductor-to-electronics cost ratios and align with India effectively monetising its 20% share of the global chip design workforce to support an 8-10% global consumption share. These figures remain highly conservative compared to China's historical 32%→36% growth trajectory during its comparable industrialisation phase.

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